SAFE-EX

UTILITY EXCAVATION SERVICES

HEALTH AND SAFETY MANUAL

Safe-Ex Inc.

Built to Go Home.

Version 1.2 | Effective October 1, 2026 | Revised October 15, 2026

Issued by Corporate Safety | Approved by the Chief Executive Officer

This manual is issued by and speaks only for Safe-Ex Inc..

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Safe-Ex Inc.

CHAPTER 1. POLICY STATEMENT AND SCOPE

The signature block and entity variables are completed at issuance at assembly.

1.1 Safety Policy

It is the policy of Safe-Ex Inc. that every person on our work goes home in the same condition they arrived. No schedule, no client demand, and no dollar amount changes that. Safe work is a condition of employment at every level of this company, and it is a condition of leadership: managers and supervisors are accountable for the safety of the people they direct.

The Company commits to the following:

- Provide the equipment, training, planning time, and staffing that safe work requires.
- Identify hazards before work begins and control them before anyone is exposed.
- Comply with every applicable safety and health regulation, and go beyond compliance where our work demands it.
- Investigate every incident and near miss to fix the system, and hold people accountable under one standard, consistently applied.
- Back every employee who stops work over a safety concern. Without exception.

Every employee commits to work by this manual, follow the 7 Rules That Keep You Alive, plan their work, look out for the person next to them, and stop work when something is wrong.

_____

Kirby Hays, Chief Executive Officer Date

1.2 Scope

This manual applies to every employee of Safe-Ex Inc., on every jobsite, facility, yard, and vehicle, on every shift. It applies to temporary employees and to any person working under the Company's direction. Subcontractors are governed by their own programs and by Chapter 22 where this entity acts as a controlling contractor.

This manual is issued by and speaks only for Safe-Ex Inc.. It creates no obligations for, and makes no statements on behalf of, any other company.

1.3 Related Programs and Order of Precedence

This manual works alongside the Employee Handbook (Part VII, Health and Safety, and Section 8.5, Discipline), the Fleet Management Program, the Combined Drug and Alcohol Policy, the Workplace Violence Prevention Plan, and client site rules and contract safety exhibits. Where requirements differ between any of these documents, or between this manual and a regulation, the stricter requirement governs. Where a client rule is stricter than ours, we follow the client rule on that client's work. Where ours is stricter, ours applies everywhere.

Nothing in this manual creates a contract of employment or alters at-will employment.

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CHAPTER 2. SAFETY ORGANIZATION AND RESPONSIBILITIES

Named persons for this entity are listed in Appendix A so personnel changes never require a manual revision.

2.1 How Responsibility Runs

Safety responsibility follows the chain of command. It is never delegated away: assigning a duty to someone does not remove it from the person above them. The named-person table for this entity, including the IIPP Administrator, is in Appendix A. Competent person designations by discipline are kept in the training matrix maintained by Corporate Safety; anyone who needs to know who is competent person trained for a task contacts Corporate Safety.

2.2 Responsibilities by Role

Chief Executive Officer

- Owns this policy. Signs it, funds it, and holds leadership accountable to it.
- Sits on the review committee for Step 3 and Step 4 discipline actions (Chapter 5.7).

Vice President

- Accountable for implementation across operations. Resolves resource conflicts in favor of safe work.
- Sits on the review committee. Reviews the central safety log and program metrics with Corporate Safety.

Corporate Safety Officer

- IIPP Administrator. Maintains this manual, the module library, the central safety log, and the training matrix.
- Reviews every discipline action above Step 1 before issuance. Leads or oversees every incident investigation (Form 10A).
- Conducts unannounced site and facility inspections and tracks corrective actions to closure.

Entity Operations Leadership

- Builds safety into schedules, budgets, and manning. A plan that cannot be executed safely is not an approved plan.
- Consulted on job impact before committee decisions are final (Chapter 5.7).

Superintendents and Foremen

- Own safety on their sites and crews. Lead pre-task planning, run tailboards, conduct inspections, enforce the rules on the spot, and document coaching in the central log.
- A supervisor who observes a violation and does not act has committed a Tier 2 violation (Chapter 5.8).

Site Safety Officers (where assigned)

- Support the superintendent with inspections, orientations, monitoring, and documentation. Assignment of an SSO does not transfer the superintendent's responsibility.

Fleet Manager

- Authority for vehicle and DOT matters under the Fleet Management Program. Chapter 25 governs the interface.

Every Employee

- Work by this manual and the 7 Rules. Inspect your equipment. Plan your task. Wear your PPE.
- Report hazards, injuries, near misses, and damage the same shift. Stop work that is not safe.

2.3 Competent Persons

Work that requires a competent person under Title 8 (excavation, scaffolds, fall protection, and others per the entity's modules) is not performed until a designated competent person is on site with the authority to stop the work and correct the hazard. Designations are made in writing by Corporate Safety based on training and demonstrated experience, and are tracked in the training matrix maintained by Corporate Safety. Anyone who needs to confirm a designation contacts Corporate Safety. Holding a card does not make a person competent; the designation does.

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CHAPTER 3. INJURY AND ILLNESS PREVENTION PROGRAM

Anchored to Cal/OSHA (T8 CCR 3203).

3.1 Purpose

This chapter is the Injury and Illness Prevention Program required by Title 8, California Code of Regulations, Section 3203. It is the framework every other chapter hangs on: who is responsible, how hazards get found and fixed, how we communicate about safety, how incidents get investigated, and how training happens. If a question is not answered elsewhere in this manual, it is answered here.

3.2 Responsibility

The IIPP Administrator for Safe-Ex Inc. is the Corporate Safety Officer, Sergio Robles, with authority and responsibility for implementing and maintaining this program. Entity operations leadership, superintendents, and foremen implement it on every site, every shift. Every employee is responsible for working safely, following this manual, and reporting hazards. The named-person table for this entity, including the Administrator and designated competent persons, is in Appendix A.

3.3 Compliance

The system for ensuring employees comply with safe work practices is Chapter 5, Enforcement and Accountability: one standard, three tiers, four steps, applied identically to everyone. Compliance is also recognized: supervisors and Corporate Safety acknowledge crews and individuals who work safely, surface hazards, and stop work when conditions call for it. Safe work is a condition of employment.

3.4 Communication

Safety communication runs in both directions, in a form readily understandable by all affected employees, including Spanish where crews require it:

- Daily pre-task planning and tailboard meetings on every crew (Chapter 7).
- Toolbox talks at least weekly, documented with topic and attendance.
- Safety alerts issued by Corporate Safety after significant incidents, near misses, or regulatory changes.
- New-hire orientation and the condensed field handbook (Chapter 23).

- Direct access: any employee may raise any safety concern to any supervisor, Corporate Safety, or Human Resources, in any language, at any time.
- Anonymous reporting: employees may report hazards anonymously to Corporate Safety, by phone or through the posted safety QR code, which links to a report form that can be submitted anonymously and is delivered directly to Corporate Safety. No employee will be retaliated against for reporting a hazard or an injury, anonymously or by name (Chapter 5.3).

3.5 Hazard Identification and Periodic Inspections

Hazards are found on a schedule and whenever conditions change, not only after something goes wrong.

- Daily: the crew inspects the work area, tools, and equipment as part of pre-task planning. Equipment operators complete the daily equipment checklist before operation.
- Weekly: the superintendent or foreman conducts and documents a site inspection on the standard checklist.
- Monthly: yards, shops, and facilities are inspected on the facility checklist by the responsible manager.
- Periodic and unannounced: Corporate Safety inspects sites and facilities across the entity, prioritized by risk and incident history.
- Event-driven: inspections are performed whenever new substances, processes, equipment, or procedures are introduced, whenever a new or previously unrecognized hazard is reported, and after any incident or near miss.

Inspection records identify the site, the date, the inspector, the hazards found, and the correction status, and are retained per Chapter 9.

3.6 Incident Investigation

Every occupational injury, illness, near miss, and property or utility damage event is investigated under Chapter 8 on Form 10A. The investigation identifies what happened, why the system allowed it, and what will prevent it, and its corrective actions are tracked to closure in the central safety log.

3.7 Hazard Correction

Hazards are corrected when found. Where correction takes time, interim protection is put in place immediately.

- Imminent hazard: work in the affected area stops now. Exposed employees are removed, and only employees necessary to correct the condition, with proper protection, may enter. Work does not resume until the hazard is corrected.
- Serious hazard: corrected before the affected work continues, and no later than the same shift.
- Other hazards: corrected on a documented schedule with a named owner, tracked to closure in the central safety log.

3.8 Training and Instruction

Training is provided when the program is first established, to every new employee at orientation, to every employee given a new job assignment for which training has not been received, whenever new substances, processes, procedures, or equipment introduce a new hazard, whenever the Company is made aware of a new or previously unrecognized hazard, and to supervisors on the hazards of the work they direct. The role-based training matrix, refresher cadences, and verification requirements are in Chapter 23. Training assigned as a condition of work is paid time.

3.9 Records

IIPP records, including inspection records and training documentation, are maintained per Chapter 9. Inspection records are retained at least one year; training records at least three years, or longer where a specific standard requires it.

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CHAPTER 4. CODE OF SAFE PRACTICES

Posted at each jobsite, or readily available with a posted notice of its location, per T8 1509. It is entity-specific and speaks only in Safe-Ex Inc.'s name.

CHAPTER 5. ENFORCEMENT AND ACCOUNTABILITY

Entity manuals are generated from this master; do not edit entity copies directly.

5.1 Purpose and Principle

This chapter sets one standard for safety accountability. The same rules, the same tiers, and the same consequences apply to every employee of Safe-Ex Inc., from a first-day laborer to the most senior superintendent, in every division and on every jobsite. Discipline under this chapter is corrective before it is punitive: the goal is that everyone goes home, every day. The Company distinguishes honest mistakes from risky drift and from conscious disregard, and it responds to each differently. What it does not do is look the other way.

This chapter works together with the Employee Handbook (Part VII, Health and Safety, and Section 8.5, Discipline). Nothing in this chapter creates a contract of employment or alters at-will employment. The Company retains discretion under Handbook Section 8.5 to apply the level of corrective action appropriate to the facts and circumstances of each case.

5.2 The 7 Rules That Keep You Alive

Seven rules cover the hazards most likely to kill or seriously injure. They are posted at every jobsite and facility, issued on a wallet card to every field employee, and signed for at orientation.

1. Tie off above 6 feet. Every time.

Ladders, scaffolds, lifts, and roofs included. Anchor points rated for 5,000 pounds.

2. Lock it. Tag it. Try it.

Verify zero energy and apply your own lock and tag before working on any energized system.

3. Know your line of fire.

Never under a suspended load, never in a swing radius, never between moving equipment and a fixed object.

4. No trench entry without protection.

Five feet or deeper requires a competent person inspection, protective systems, and egress within 25 feet.

5. Live track and live traffic kill.

No one fouls a track or steps into a traffic lane until on-track safety or traffic control is established and the briefing is complete.

6. Seatbelts on. Spotter when backing. Phone down.

Every vehicle, every piece of mobile equipment, every shift. A spotter is required whenever backing or offloading where any person could be in the path or where vision is limited. Working alone, a documented walk-around immediately before the move is the accepted alternative.

7. Show up ready to work.

Free of impairment from drugs, alcohol, or fatigue. Disclose any medication that affects alertness before your shift.

5.3 Stop Work Authority and Anti-Retaliation

Every employee has the authority and the obligation to stop any work they reasonably believe is unsafe. Work does not resume until the condition is corrected and the person who stopped the work, or a supervisor, confirms it is safe to proceed. No employee will ever be disciplined, demoted, reassigned, or treated worse for stopping work in good faith, reporting a hazard, reporting an injury, or refusing unsafe work. Retaliation against an employee who exercises stop work authority or reports in good faith is itself a Tier 1 violation and grounds for termination of the retaliating employee, including supervisors.

5.4 The Three Violation Tiers

Tier	Definition	Examples	Entry Point
Tier 1. Life-Critical	Conduct that could kill or seriously injure. Violations of the 7 Rules.	Untied at heights; LOTO bypass; line-of-fire violation; unprotected trench entry; fouling live track or traffic without protection; removing or disabling a safety device; working impaired.	Enters at Step 3. Reckless conduct enters at Step 4.
Tier 2. Major Operational	Serious failure of judgment, process, or care that creates significant risk, cost, or exposure. The test: did this violation, by itself, create real risk, cost, or exposure to the company, the public, or the crew — regardless of whether anyone got hurt or anything actually broke? If yes, it's Tier 2.	Negligent equipment damage with skipped procedure; operating outside qualifications; refusing PPE after correction; concealing damage or an incident; supervisor failure to enforce; retaliation-adjacent conduct.	Enters at Step 2.
Tier 3. Process	The daily disciplines that	Missed PPE; missed JHA	Enters at Step 1.

Compliance	prevent everything else. The test: did this violation weaken a safeguard or process step without creating risk, cost, or exposure on its own — something that only matters if something else also goes wrong? If yes, it's Tier 3.	or pre-task plan; missed equipment checklist; missed toolbox attendance; housekeeping after a request.	

Falsification of any safety record, inspection, timecard, or qualification document is treated outside the ordinary ladder: a single proven instance is grounds for termination regardless of tier.

5.5 Behavior Classification (Just Culture)

The tier sets the entry point. Before any Step 3 or Step 4 action, the review committee classifies the behavior. Same act, different intent, different response.

Classification	Meaning	Response
Human Error	An honest mistake by someone trying to do the right thing, often set up by a system, training, or tool gap.	Console the person. Fix the system. No discipline.
At-Risk Behavior	Drift from the rule because the risk was not seen, was rationalized, or had become normal on the crew. The most common finding.	Coach, document, retrain. The tier entry point applies. Repeat preventable events escalate per the rules in 5.6.
Reckless Behavior	Knew the rule, knew the risk, chose to ignore it.	Escalation above the entry point. Reckless Tier 1 conduct is grounds for termination.
No-Fault / System Failure	No employee behavior contribution: procedures were followed and the system still produced the outcome.	No discipline of any kind. The system is examined and fixed; the event is logged for trend analysis.

The substitution test: would three other employees with the same training, at the same skill level, in the same conditions, likely have made the same choice? If yes, the problem is the system and the fix is the system. If no, the classification above governs.

For Tier 1 violations, the Company may impose any step up to and including termination based on the totality of the circumstances, including the potential for harm, the vulnerability of the public or the crew, client and site requirements, and the employee's overall record. The tiers

describe the ordinary response; they do not limit the Company's discretion under Handbook Section 8.5.

5.6 The Four-Step Ladder

Step	Action	Approval Required
Step 1. Documented Coaching	The supervisor reports the event to the Corporate Safety Officer the same shift. The Corporate Safety Officer conducts and documents the coaching conversation with the employee, and logs it in the central safety log within 48 hours. Not a formal write-up. Documented coaching is conducted by the Corporate Safety Officer only; no one else delivers it.	Corporate Safety Officer
Step 2. Written Warning	Formal written warning, signed by the employee, filed in the personnel file and the central log. Retraining assigned within 14 days is paid time.	Review Committee
Step 3. Stand-Down (1 to 3 days, unpaid for non-exempt employees)	Removal from work. Documented re-orientation with Corporate Safety before return. A subsequent violation within 12 months results in termination. For exempt employees, unpaid suspension is structured in full workweek increments or as accrued PTO use, per wage and hour law.	Review Committee
Step 4. Termination	Separation after investigation. Final pay and separation requirements per state law.	Review Committee, with HR execution

Prior record. An employee's record includes all documented discipline and preventable incidents, including those documented before this program's effective date. The Review Committee considers the full record on every recommendation of Step 2 or higher. At adoption of this revision, Corporate Safety and Human Resources enter existing documented discipline and preventable incidents from the prior 12 months into the central safety log as opening history.

Repeat events. A second preventable Tier 1 or Tier 2 event within 12 months enters the ladder one step above the tier entry point. A third preventable event within 12 months is referred to the Review Committee for a termination decision, regardless of tier. Event counts are tracked in the central safety log.

Introductory period. During an employee's first 90 days of employment, the progressive ladder does not bind the Company. Any Tier 1 or Tier 2 event classified as At-Risk or Reckless Behavior during the introductory period is routed directly to the Review Committee as an employment suitability decision, with termination available at entry. Events classified No-Fault / System Failure or Human Error, stopping work in good faith, and honest reporting are never grounds for action under this paragraph, during the introductory period or at any other time.

Active Steps 1 through 3 reset after 12 months of violation-free work, tracked in the central safety log. Time spent in required retraining is paid for all employees.

5.7 The Review Committee

One committee reviews every proposed Step 3 and Step 4 action, every introductory period routing and third-event referral under Section 5.6, and every driving event escalation under the Driver Acceptability Standards: the Chief Executive Officer, the Vice President, the Corporate Safety Officer, and the Human Resources Manager, or their written designees. Field operations leadership is consulted on job impact before decisions are final but is not a required approver. No Step 3 or Step 4 action is issued without committee review, and no supervisor may promise or impose one on their own. Corporate Safety reviews every action above Step 1 before it is issued to keep classification and consequences consistent across all divisions and entities.

5.8 Supervisors Are Accountable for Enforcement

A supervisor who observes a violation and does not act has committed a Tier 2 violation. Enforcement is not optional and it is not personal. Supervisors document coaching conversations, correct hazards on the spot, and escalate what they cannot correct. Leadership backs supervisors who hold the line.

5.9 Driving Events

Driving and vehicle events are governed by the Driver Acceptability Standards and Disciplinary Matrix and the Fleet Management Program. Where a driving event is also a violation of the 7 Rules (for example, seatbelt not worn, handheld phone in motion, or operating impaired), the safety tier sets the minimum response and the review committee resolves both tracks in a single decision. One event, one committee, one outcome.

5.10 Employees Covered by a Collective Bargaining Agreement

This section applies to all Safe-Ex Inc. craft employees covered by a collective bargaining agreement.

The safety rules in this manual, the 7 Rules, stop work authority, and the violation tiers apply identically to every employee, including employees covered by a collective bargaining agreement. For CBA-covered employees, the procedure for imposing discipline, including notice,

representation, and grievance rights, follows the applicable agreement. Nothing in any agreement limits the Company's authority to remove an employee from work immediately for a safety violation pending the contractual process. Where this chapter and a CBA procedure differ, the CBA procedure governs the process; the safety standard itself does not change.

Safe-Ex agreement: Operating Engineers Local 12.

5.11 The Central Safety Log

Every coaching, warning, stand-down, termination, incident, near miss, and stop work event is entered in the central safety log maintained by Corporate Safety within 48 hours. Corporate Safety keeps the log current. Monthly, Corporate Safety provides the log to the Review Committee with an analysis of trends and recommended actions to prevent what the log shows developing.

5.12 Equipment Damage

All damage to equipment, vehicles, tools, and property, whether owned, rented, client, or third party, is reported, investigated, and resolved under this section. The purpose is the same as the rest of this program: find and fix the system, hold knowing violations accountable, and never give anyone a reason to hide damage.

Reporting. All damage, however minor, is reported to the supervisor and the Corporate Safety Officer the same shift it occurs or is discovered (Chapter 8.1). A scratch reported is a repair; a scratch hidden is a falsification problem. Damaged equipment that could affect safe operation is taken out of service, tagged, and not returned until cleared. Damage involving a utility, the public, a client's property, or a regulator follows Chapter 8 in full.

Investigation. Damage events are investigated on Form 10A with a Form 10A-1 for each employee involved. The first question is always behavioral: were all applicable procedures followed? If yes, the event is No-Fault / System Failure: no discipline of any kind. The damage is logged, the system is examined, and corrective actions are assigned with named owners and due dates. If a procedure was not followed, the behavior is classified under this chapter: human error, at-risk behavior (coached by the Corporate Safety Officer, documented, retrained), or reckless conduct (tier assignment and the discipline ladder).

A violation of a 7 Rules requirement in a damage event (seatbelt, spotter, raised bed, lockout) is a Tier 1 matter regardless of the damage amount. Concealing damage, or falsifying an inspection, checklist, or record connected to it, is outside the ladder entirely: a single proven instance is a terminable offense, routed directly to the Review Committee.

Discipline keys to behavior, never to the repair bill. A $50,000 failure with every procedure followed is a No-Fault system event. A $200 mirror knocked off while backing without a spotter is a 7 Rules violation. Repair costs are recorded in the central safety log for trend analysis only.

The moment discipline follows dollars, small damage disappears underground and surfaces later as big damage.

Tracking. Every damage event is entered in the central safety log within 48 hours with unit, description, estimated cost, classification, and corrective actions. Repeat events on the same unit, crew, or cause are flagged in the monthly Review Committee report with recommended prevention actions. Vehicle events that are also DOT matters follow the Fleet Management Program: one event, one investigation, one committee.

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CHAPTER 6. STOP WORK AUTHORITY

This chapter expands the standard set in Chapter 5.3 into the working procedure.

6.1 The Authority

Every employee of Safe-Ex Inc., regardless of position, seniority, or trade, has the authority and the obligation to stop any work they reasonably believe presents a danger to any person, the public, or a utility. The authority extends to stopping the work of other crews and, on our sites, the work of subcontractors. No permission is needed. No justification beyond a good-faith concern is required. A stop work call made in good faith is never wrong, even when the concern turns out to be unfounded.

6.2 How Work Gets Stopped

- Say it plainly: STOP WORK. Address the person in the hazard first, the supervisor second.
- Make the area safe. Remove people from exposure. Do not attempt to correct an imminent hazard alone or without protection.
- Notify the supervisor immediately. The supervisor notifies Corporate Safety the same shift for any stop involving a life-critical hazard, a utility, the public, or a subcontractor.

6.3 Restart

Work resumes only when all three are true: the condition is corrected or controlled, the person who stopped the work or the supervisor confirms it is safe to proceed, and the crew is briefed on what changed. If the person who stopped the work and the supervisor disagree on whether it is safe to resume, the work stays stopped and the question goes to Corporate Safety. Corporate Safety's call is final.

6.4 Documentation

Every stop work event is entered in the central safety log within 48 hours: who stopped it, what the condition was, how it was corrected, and when work resumed. Stop work events are reviewed for system lessons, never for blame. Crews and individuals who make good stop work calls are recognized for them.

6.5 No Retaliation

Chapter 5.3 applies in full. Retaliation against any person for stopping work or raising a concern in good faith is a Tier 1 violation and grounds for termination of the retaliating employee, including supervisors.

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CHAPTER 7. PRE-TASK PLANNING

One form set is used group-wide; the forms are indexed in Appendix B.

7.1 The Daily Plan

The daily plan is executed on the daily tailboard record issued for this entity, completed and signed by every crew member each shift, with the task-level Job Safety Analysis redone whenever the task, the site, or conditions change.

No task starts without a plan. Every crew completes a written Job Hazard Analysis / Pre-Task Plan (JHA/PTP) at the start of every shift, for every task, on the standard form. The plan is written at the work location, by the crew that will do the work, led by the foreman or the most senior person on the task. It covers, at minimum:

- The steps of the task, in order.
- The hazards of each step, including utilities, energy sources, traffic, weather, adjacent crews, and the public.
- The controls for each hazard, named specifically: which protective system, which barrier, which permit, which PPE.
- Who is assigned to each role, including competent persons, spotters, and flaggers where the work requires them.
- The manual handling on the task: the heaviest and most repetitive lift, the aid or method to be used, and who rotates (Chapter 17).
- Emergency information: nearest medical facility, muster point, and who calls 911.

7.2 The Tailboard

The plan is worthless if the crew has not heard it. The foreman briefs the full crew on the plan before work begins. Every crew member signs the JHA/PTP. Anyone who joins the crew mid-shift is briefed and signs before starting work. Questions at the tailboard are a strength: a crew member who does not understand the plan says so, and the plan is explained or fixed.

7.3 Changed Conditions

The plan matches the work or the work stops. When conditions change (different task, different location, weather, an unexpected utility, new equipment, a new crew member, or anything the plan did not anticipate), work pauses and the plan is redone or amended before work continues. A plan written for the morning does not cover an afternoon that looks different.

7.4 Documentation and Quality

Completed JHA/PTP forms are retained per Chapter 9 and are reviewed by superintendents on their weekly inspections and by Corporate Safety on site visits. The standard is a real plan for the real work of that day. A pre-filled, copied, or generic form is not a plan; a form signed by people who were not briefed is falsification under Chapter 5.4, and both are treated accordingly.

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CHAPTER 8. INCIDENT INVESTIGATION AND REPORTING

Form 10A is the standard investigation record group-wide.

8.1 What Gets Reported, and When

Every employee reports the following to their supervisor immediately, and in no case later than the end of the shift in which it occurred. The supervisor reports to Corporate Safety the same shift.

- Any injury or illness, however minor. First aid cases included.
- Any near miss: an event that could have caused injury, damage, or a utility strike under slightly different circumstances.
- Any utility contact or damage, any equipment or property damage, and any vehicle event.
- Any fire, spill, or release.
- Any contact from a regulator, and any incident involving the public or a client's facilities.

Late reporting is a Tier 2 violation. Concealing an incident is treated at Step 3 minimum, and falsifying a report is single-instance terminable under Chapter 5.4. Reporting an incident honestly is never, by itself, the basis for discipline.

8.2 Immediate Response and Scene Preservation

- People first: care for the injured, remove others from exposure, and call 911 where warranted. First aid and medical services per Chapter 14.
- Make the scene safe, then leave it alone. After a serious incident, nothing is moved, altered, or cleaned up except to rescue, prevent further harm, or as directed by responders, until Corporate Safety releases the scene.
- Photograph conditions as found. Identify witnesses and separate them for statements while memory is fresh.

8.3 External Reporting

Corporate Safety makes all regulatory notifications. In California, any serious injury or illness, or any death, is reported to Cal/OSHA immediately and in no case more than 8 hours after the Company knows or should have known of it (T8 CCR 342). Utility damage notifications, environmental releases, DOT-reportable events, and client notifications follow the applicable module and contract. No employee makes a regulatory or media statement about an incident; inquiries go to Corporate Safety and leadership.

8.4 The Investigation

Every reportable event under 8.1 is investigated on Form 10A. Corporate Safety leads or oversees the investigation; the supervisor of the affected work participates. Investigations begin within 24 hours and are completed promptly, with serious incidents given priority over all other safety work. The investigation establishes the facts, the sequence, the direct causes, and the system causes: what about our planning, training, equipment, supervision, or procedures allowed this to happen.

Behavior found in the investigation is classified under Chapter 5.5 before any discipline is proposed. The investigation answers what happened and why. The review committee answers what follows from it.

8.5 Corrective Actions

Every investigation produces corrective actions with a named owner and a due date, entered in the central safety log and tracked to closure. Corrective actions that change a rule, a procedure, or a module trigger an update to this manual under the version control process, and a safety alert to affected crews where warranted. Any module touched by an incident investigation is reviewed immediately.

8.6 Post-Incident Testing and Claims

Post-incident drug and alcohol testing is governed by the Combined Drug and Alcohol Policy, including its DOT riders. Testing decisions follow that policy's criteria, never assumption or accusation. Injury claims, medical management, and return to work are handled under Chapter 24 and the claims protocol; supervisors report claims information to Corporate Safety and HR only.

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CHAPTER 9. RECORDKEEPING AND RECORDS ACCESS

Anchored to Cal/OSHA (T8 CCR 14300 series, 3204). 1020.

9.1 Principle

Records are how this program proves itself: to a regulator, to a carrier, to a court, and to ourselves. A record that does not exist, cannot be found, or was filled in after the fact is worse than no program at all. Every record required by this manual has an owner, a home, and a retention period. Falsification of any record is single-instance terminable under Chapter 5.4.

9.2 Injury and Illness Recordkeeping

- Corporate Safety maintains the OSHA 300 Log and 301 incident reports for Safe-Ex Inc.. Recordable cases are entered within 7 calendar days of learning of them. Recordability decisions are made by Corporate Safety, never by a supervisor in the field.
- The 300A annual summary is certified by entity executive leadership and posted at each establishment from February 1 through April 30, and submitted electronically where size and industry thresholds require it.
- Logs and summaries are retained 5 years and updated when case status changes.
- Privacy cases are handled per the regulation: the name comes off the log, the case stays on it.

9.3 Program Records and Retention

Record	Owner	Retention
JHA/PTP forms, tailboards, toolbox talks	Superintendent files to Corporate Safety	1 year minimum
Inspection records (site, facility, equipment)	Corporate Safety	1 year minimum
Training and orientation records, acknowledgments, certifications	Corporate Safety training matrix	3 years minimum, and for the duration of the certification
Incident investigations (Form 10A) and corrective actions	Corporate Safety, central safety log	5 years
Discipline records under Chapter 5	HR personnel file and central safety log	Per HR retention schedule
Employee exposure and medical records	HR / Corporate Safety, confidential	Duration of employment plus 30 years (T8 3204)
Permits (confined space, hot work, excavation, client permits)	Superintendent files to Corporate Safety	1 year, or per the governing standard

9.4 Employee Access

Any employee, former employee, or their designated representative may request their own exposure and medical records under T8 3204 and the injury log entries the regulation entitles them to see. Requests go to Corporate Safety or HR and are fulfilled within the regulatory timelines. Medical records are confidential and are released only as the regulation and the employee's authorization allow.

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CHAPTER 10. HAZARD COMMUNICATION

Anchored to Cal/OSHA (T8 CCR 5194). 1200.

10.1 Purpose and Scope

Employees have the right to know what chemicals they work with and around, what those chemicals can do to them, and how to protect themselves. This program covers every hazardous chemical used or stored by Safe-Ex Inc.: fuels, oils, solvents, adhesives, concrete and masonry products, compressed gases, paints and coatings, and shop chemicals. It applies on our sites, in our yards and shops, and in our vehicles.

10.2 Chemical Inventory and Safety Data Sheets

- Corporate Safety maintains the master chemical inventory for the entity. Superintendents and yard managers keep their location list current; no new chemical is brought into use until its SDS is on file and any needed controls are in place.
- An SDS for every chemical at a location is accessible to every employee on that location during every shift, without asking permission: in the site or shop SDS binder, or electronically where reliable access exists, with a backup when it does not.
- If an SDS is missing, the chemical is not used until it is obtained.

10.3 Labels

- Manufacturer containers keep their labels, legible and intact. A container with a damaged or missing label is taken out of service until relabeled.
- A compliant label includes six elements: product identifier, signal word (Danger or Warning), hazard statement(s), pictogram(s), precautionary statement(s), and the supplier's name, address, and phone number. A label missing any of these is treated the same as a damaged or missing label under this section.
- Secondary containers (spray bottles, fuel cans, small mix containers) are labeled with the product identity and hazard warnings. The only exception is a container used immediately and completely by the person who filled it, within the shift.
- Fuel and chemical transfer containers meet the applicable container standards. Food and drink containers are never used for chemicals. Ever.

10.4 Training

Every employee is trained at orientation and whenever a new hazard is introduced: how to read a label and an SDS, the physical and health hazards of the chemical categories in their work —

including simple asphyxiants and combustible dust where present, such as confined space atmospheres and silica-generating work — how to detect a release, the protective measures and PPE required, and where the inventory and SDS collection live. Training is in a language and manner the employee understands, and is documented per Chapter 9.

10.5 Non-Routine Tasks and Multi-Employer Sites

- Before a non-routine task involving chemicals (tank or equipment cleaning, demolition of coated or treated materials, unexpected containers found in an excavation), the supervisor and Corporate Safety review the hazards and controls at the pre-task plan. Unknown containers or suspect materials stop the work until identified.
- On multi-employer sites, we inform other employers of the hazardous chemicals our work exposes their people to, provide SDS access, and obtain the same from them. Their chemical hazards go into our crew's pre-task plan.
- On client-controlled sites, the client's hazard communication program applies alongside this chapter; the stricter provision governs.
- Corporate Safety verifies on rotation: SDS accessible without delay, labels intact on primary and secondary containers, non-routine task hazards reviewed before work starts, and training documented per Chapter 9.

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CHAPTER 11. PERSONAL PROTECTIVE EQUIPMENT

The entity PPE table and any FR/arc-rated requirements are set out in Appendix A and work modules.

11.1 Principle

PPE is the last line of defense, never the first. Hazards are eliminated, substituted, engineered out, or controlled by procedure before PPE is relied on. But the last line holds: where PPE is required, wearing it correctly is a condition of being on the work, and a missed-PPE violation enters the discipline ladder at Step 1 under Chapter 5.

11.2 Hazard Assessment

Corporate Safety certifies a written PPE hazard assessment for the entity's operations, by work type, reviewed annually and whenever the work changes. The assessment drives the entity PPE table in the skin. The daily JHA/PTP is the task-level assessment: it names the PPE for that day's work, including anything above the standard set.

11.3 Minimum Field Standard

On every jobsite and in every yard and shop work area, unless Appendix A or a work module sets more:

- Hard hat, ANSI Z89.1.
- Safety glasses, ANSI Z87.1. Face shield over them for cutting, grinding, chipping, and chemical splash.
- High-visibility apparel, Class 2 minimum; Class 3 for night work and where the traffic control module requires it.
- Safety-toe boots in serviceable condition, ASTM F2413.
- Gloves matched to the task: cut-rated for handling, chemical-rated for chemicals, leather for general work.
- Hearing protection in posted areas and around high-noise equipment. Respiratory, fall, FR, and arc-rated equipment per the applicable work module and the entity table.

11.4 Provision, Fit, and Care

- The Company provides required PPE at no cost to employees, in the sizes its people need. Prescription-compatible eye protection is accommodated.

- PPE is inspected by the wearer before each use. Damaged, expired, or contaminated PPE is removed from service and replaced; there is no discipline for asking for replacement gear, only for working without it.
- Fall protection, respirators, and other life-critical PPE are inspected, fitted, and maintained per their governing modules, including fit testing and medical evaluation where required.

11.5 Enforcement

Supervisors verify PPE at the tailboard and throughout the shift. Visitors and subcontractor personnel on our sites meet the same minimums or leave the work area.

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CHAPTER 12. HEAT ILLNESS PREVENTION

Anchored to Cal/OSHA (T8 CCR 3395 outdoor; T8 CCR 3396 indoor where applicable). The Fed OSHA base text carries the equivalent program with AZ addendum triggers.

12.1 Purpose

Heat kills workers in our climate and our trades every year, and it is entirely preventable. This chapter is the entity's written Heat Illness Prevention Plan. It is available at every worksite, and the supervisor running the work is responsible for executing it every hot day, without being asked.

12.2 Water

Fresh, pure, suitably cool drinking water is available at no cost, as close as practicable to the work, in quantities sufficient for at least one quart per employee per hour for the full shift. Supervisors encourage frequent drinking; nobody waits until they are thirsty. Water service is checked at the start of the shift and replenished before it runs low.

12.3 Shade

When the outdoor temperature exceeds 80 degrees, shade is up and available: enough for all employees on a rest or meal break to sit in full shade without crowding, as close as practicable to the work. Below 80 degrees, shade is provided on request. Employees who need a preventative cool-down rest take one, are monitored, and are never ordered back to work until symptoms are gone; a cool-down rest is paid time and lasts no less than 5 minutes in the shade.

12.4 Acclimatization

New employees, employees returning from time away, and everyone during a heat wave are at the highest risk. Supervisors closely observe new and newly assigned employees for their first 14 days of hot work, and all employees during a heat wave or the first hot spell of the season. Workload and pace are adjusted while bodies adapt. Being new is a risk factor, and the schedule respects it.

12.5 High-Heat Procedures (95 Degrees and Above)

- Pre-shift meeting covering the high-heat plan, water, symptoms, and the buddy system.
- Effective observation of every employee: a mandatory buddy system, supervisor observation of 20 or fewer employees, or regular communication with anyone working alone.

- Effective communication maintained with every employee (voice, radio, or observation; a phone only where reception is reliable).
- Reminders to drink water throughout the shift, and rest breaks taken in shade.

12.6 Emergency Response

- Every crew knows the signs: heavy sweating, cramps, headache, and fatigue mean heat exhaustion; confusion, staggering, hot dry skin, or collapse mean heat stroke, and heat stroke is a 911 call, immediately.
- A sick employee is never left alone and never sent home or to their vehicle unaccompanied. Move them to shade, cool them aggressively (water, wet cloth, airflow), and get medical help per the severity.
- Every site's emergency information (Chapter 7 pre-task plan) includes clear directions for responders to the work location, especially remote and right-of-way work.

12.7 Indoor Heat

Scope and Definition

This section applies to indoor places of employment: any space under a ceiling or overhead covering that restricts airflow, enclosed along its entire perimeter by walls, doors, windows, dividers, or other barriers that restrict airflow, whether open or closed. Shops, warehouses, enclosed structures, and covered spaces that meet this description are indoor for purposes of this section, regardless of how they're used. A covered structure that is not enclosed along its entire perimeter is not indoor; it follows the outdoor provisions in Sections 12.2 through 12.6 instead. Yard and shop managers determine which of their spaces meet this definition and document that determination.

The Two Triggers

Indoor heat illness prevention has two levels, and they are not the same obligation:

At 82 degrees or above, when employees are present, the baseline requirements apply: water, a cool-down area, effective emergency response, and training.

At 87 degrees or above, or at 82 degrees where employees wear clothing that restricts heat removal or work in a high-radiant-heat area, the full requirements apply: everything in the baseline, plus temperature and heat index monitoring, recordkeeping, the controls hierarchy in Part E, and written indoor heat illness prevention measures for that space.

A space that only ever reaches the first threshold does not automatically require the second tier's controls or monitoring. A space that reaches the second threshold requires both.

Water and Cool-Down Areas

Fresh, pure, suitably cool drinking water is available at no cost, as close as practicable to the work, per the same standard as Section 12.2.

A cool-down area is maintained below 82 degrees, shielded from direct sunlight and radiant heat sources, sized for the number of employees who might use it at one time, and located close

enough to be practical. Employees who take a preventative cool-down rest are monitored and are never ordered back before symptoms resolve, per the same standard as Section 12.3.

Monitoring and Recordkeeping

Where a work area meets the 87-degree trigger (or the qualifying 82-degree conditions in Part B), the supervisor:

Measures and records temperature and heat index in that work area.

Identifies and evaluates other environmental risk factors for heat illness present in that space (radiant heat sources, humidity, air movement, clothing/PPE requirements).

Keeps those records available at the site.

Controls Hierarchy

Where the 87-degree trigger applies, controls are applied in this order:

Engineering controls first: reduce and maintain temperature and heat index below 87 degrees, or below 82 degrees where employees wear heat-restrictive clothing or work in a high-radiant-heat area. Fans, ventilation, insulation, spot cooling, and isolating process heat sources are typical measures.

Administrative controls, where engineering controls alone are not sufficient: adjusted work/rest schedules, rotation, and rescheduling heat-generating tasks.

Personal heat-protective equipment, only where the employer demonstrates that feasible engineering and administrative controls do not sufficiently minimize the risk, and only to the extent equipment is feasible for the task.

Written Indoor Heat Illness Prevention Measures

For each indoor space meeting the 87-degree trigger, the supervisor maintains a written record of: which controls from Part E are in place, who is responsible for implementing them, and how compliance is verified. This is reviewed and updated when conditions or the space itself change.

Acclimatization and Training

The acclimatization protections in Section 12.4 apply to employees newly assigned to hot indoor work the same way they apply to outdoor work: close observation for the first 14 days, and adjusted workload and pace while the body adapts.

Training under Section 12.8 includes, for employees who may work in indoor heat: how to identify whether a space is indoor under Part A, the two-trigger structure in Part B, the specific controls in place at their facility under Part E, and the vehicle/container exception in Part G.

12.8 Training

Every employee and supervisor is trained on this chapter before hot work, including risk factors, the Company's procedures, the importance of water and acclimatization, symptom recognition, and emergency response. Supervisors are additionally trained on their monitoring and response duties and on how weather triggers each procedure.

CHAPTER 13. EMERGENCY ACTION AND FIRE PROTECTION

Facility-specific plans and maps are set out in Appendix A.

13.1 Scope

This chapter covers emergencies at fixed facilities (offices, yards, shops) and on jobsites: fire, medical emergency, severe weather, earthquake, utility emergencies, and any event requiring evacuation. Site-specific emergency information for field work lives in the daily pre-task plan (Chapter 7); this chapter sets the standard that plan must meet.

13.2 Emergency Action Plan

- Every facility has a posted evacuation map, designated exit routes kept clear at all times, a muster point, and a way to account for everyone on the property, including visitors.
- Every jobsite tailboard establishes the same three things daily: how the alarm is raised, where people go, and who accounts for the crew and calls 911.
- Alarm and notification: any employee who discovers an emergency raises the alarm first by the fastest means, then acts. On multi-employer sites, our alarm reaches the other employers' crews and theirs reaches ours; the controlling contractor's system governs.
- After any evacuation, nobody re-enters until the incident commander or responding agency clears it. Headcount discrepancies are reported to responders immediately; employees do not re-enter to search.
- Corporate Safety designates a person by name and title responsible for maintaining this chapter's plan and answering employee questions about it, and a person by name and title at each facility responsible for maintaining equipment that controls ignition sources and fuel hazards (fueling stations, heat-producing equipment, flammable storage). Both are named in the facility's Appendix A package.

13.3 Utility Emergencies

A struck gas line, downed or damaged electrical line, or damaged pressurized main is treated as a life threat, not a repair problem. Evacuate upwind and uphill for gas, establish distance for electrical (assume energized, minimum 30 feet, more for high voltage), eliminate ignition sources, call 911 and the utility owner, and keep the public back. The crew protects people and the perimeter; the utility owner makes it safe. Detailed procedures are in the underground utilities and electrical work modules.

13.4 Severe Weather and Earthquake

- Lightning within 10 miles (flash-to-bang 30 seconds or less) suspends exposed elevated work, crane operations, and open-field work until 30 minutes after the last strike.
- High wind suspends crane, hoisting, and panel operations per the equipment manual and the lift plan. Rain that defeats excavation protection or traffic control visibility suspends that work under the governing module.
- Earthquake: drop, cover, hold on inside; in the open, move clear of structures, poles, and lines. After shaking stops, evacuate per the plan, account for everyone, and treat every utility as suspect until inspected.

13.5 Fire Prevention and Protection

- Fuels, flammables, and compressed gases are stored, separated, and secured per the applicable standards; ignition sources are controlled around them, and refueling is done engine-off with bonding where required.
- Hot work (welding, cutting, grinding near combustibles) is performed under the hot work module with a fire watch where required.
- Portable extinguishers are provided at facilities, on jobsites, in company vehicles per the fleet standard, and on equipment where the module requires them: mounted, charged, accessible, visually checked monthly, and serviced annually.
- Extinguishers are distributed so travel distance never exceeds 75 feet for Class A hazards (ordinary combustibles) or 50 feet for Class B hazards (flammable liquids); Class C areas follow whichever of those patterns fits the underlying A or B hazard. Extinguisher type is matched to the hazard present — a Class B-rated unit alone is not sufficient where ordinary combustibles are also present.
- Employees are trained at orientation on extinguisher use and its limit: small, contained, early-stage fires only, with an exit at your back. Anything more is an evacuation and a 911 call. Fighting the fire is never required.
- Oily rags, packaging, sawdust, and other combustible waste are collected in covered metal containers and removed from the work area at the end of each shift; accumulation is not allowed to build up around ignition sources, exits, or extinguisher locations.

13.6 Drills and Review

Facilities conduct an evacuation drill at least annually, documented with date and attendance. The plan is reviewed after every drill, every real activation, and any facility change, and the lessons go into the master via the version control process. Every employee is trained on this chapter's plan before their first assignment, and retrained whenever their role changes in a way that affects their emergency duties or the plan itself changes. This is separate from and in addition to the annual evacuation drill.

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CHAPTER 14. FIRST AID AND MEDICAL SERVICES

Designated clinics and facility postings are set out in Appendix A.

14.1 Trained Personnel

Every crew and every facility has ready access to a person currently certified in first aid and CPR. For field crews, that person is on the crew: certifications are tracked in the training matrix, planned into crew assignments by dispatch and the superintendent, and verified at pre-mobilization. Remote and right-of-way work is staffed so that trained response does not depend on outside help arriving quickly.

14.2 Supplies

- First aid kits sized to the crew are on every jobsite, in every crew truck per the fleet standard, and at every facility: inspected and restocked monthly and after every use, protected from dust and moisture, and matched to the hazards of the work per the modules (burn care, eye wash, trauma dressings where the work warrants).
- Where employees may be exposed to injurious corrosive materials, plumbed or portable eyewash meeting the standard is available at the work area, inspected on schedule.
- AEDs installed at facilities are inspected monthly and their locations posted.

14.3 Getting Help

- Every pre-task plan and every facility posting identifies: emergency numbers, the address or coordinates of the work, driving directions for responders, and the nearest emergency room and designated occupational clinic.
- Life threat, altered consciousness, uncontrolled bleeding, suspected spine injury, chest pain, heat stroke: call 911. Do not drive the person. For injuries below that line, a supervisor arranges transport to the designated clinic; an injured employee does not drive themselves.
- The supervisor notifies Corporate Safety the same shift for every injury, however minor, per Chapter 8. First aid cases are logged even when no treatment beyond the kit is needed.

14.4 Bloodborne Pathogens

Employees designated as first aid responders and employees whose duties include cleanup of blood or bodily fluids are covered by the entity's bloodborne pathogens exposure control program: universal precautions, gloves and barriers in every kit, proper cleanup and disposal, hepatitis B vaccination offered per the standard, and immediate reporting and medical follow-

up for any exposure incident. Nobody cleans up blood bare-handed, and no exposure goes unreported.

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CHAPTER 15. FIT FOR DUTY, DRUG AND ALCOHOL, AND FATIGUE

The Combined Drug and Alcohol Policy is the single source of truth for all testing; this chapter does not duplicate it.

15.1 Fit for Duty

Rule 7 of the 7 Rules: show up ready to work, free of impairment from drugs, alcohol, or fatigue. Fitness for duty is a condition of every shift, and it covers prescription and over-the-counter medication: any employee taking a medication that can affect alertness, judgment, coordination, or reaction time discloses it to their supervisor before the shift. The conversation is about the effect, never the diagnosis; medical information stays confidential with HR. Work assignments are adjusted while the effect lasts, and disclosure is never, by itself, the basis for discipline.

15.2 Drug and Alcohol Policy

All drug and alcohol requirements, prohibitions, and testing (pre-employment, reasonable suspicion, post-incident, random, and return-to-duty, including DOT programs under 49 CFR Part 382 and any FRA or PHMSA riders that apply to the entity's work) are governed by the Combined Drug and Alcohol Policy. That policy is the single source of truth. Where this manual and that policy touch the same subject, that policy governs the testing process and this manual governs the safety consequence: working impaired is a Tier 1 violation under Chapter 5, and refusal to test is treated as the policy provides.

Supervisors are trained to recognize the signs of impairment and to act on them: an employee reasonably suspected of impairment is removed from work immediately, not sent to their vehicle and not left operating anything, and the reasonable suspicion process in the policy is followed the same shift.

15.3 Fatigue

Fatigue impairs like alcohol does, and it is managed like the hazard it is:

- Scheduling: work hours, night work, and consecutive days are planned with fatigue in mind. Hours-of-service rules govern covered drivers per the Fleet Management Program; extended shifts elsewhere get supervisor attention, not autopilot approval.
- Self-declaration: an employee too fatigued to work safely says so to their supervisor, before the shift or during it. A good-faith fatigue declaration is never disciplined; the response is an

assignment adjustment, rest, or a safe way home. Nobody drives home dangerously tired because they were afraid to say it.

- Night work: lighting, task rotation, and check-ins per the applicable module. Supervisors watch their crews for fatigue the same way they watch for heat illness.

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CHAPTER 16. HOUSEKEEPING AND WALKING-WORKING SURFACES

Slips, trips, and struck-by events are among this group's most frequent injuries; this chapter is a working control set, not a slogan.

16.1 The Standard

A clean site is a safe site, and it is also the public face of the Company. Housekeeping is part of the work, built into every task, every crew, every day. Clean as you go: debris, scrap, and packaging are removed as they are generated, not at the end of the week. The last hour of demobilization includes leaving the area clean.

16.2 Access and Walking Surfaces

- Walkways, stairs, ramps, and access routes are kept clear of materials, cords, hoses, tools, and mud buildup. A blocked exit route is corrected now, not noted for later.
- Cords and hoses crossing walkways are elevated, ramped, or routed around; crossing traffic areas, they are protected. Ground conditions (mud, ice, standing water, uneven backfill) are corrected, covered, or barricaded and lit.
- Holes and floor openings are covered per the fall protection module: secured, marked, and rated for the load, never a loose sheet of plywood.
- Work areas, stairs, and access routes have adequate lighting for the shift being worked; night work lighting per the applicable module.

16.3 Materials and Struck-By

- Materials are staged stable, stacked per manufacturer limits, banded or blocked against shifting, clear of edges, openings, and traffic lanes, and never within the buffer of a traffic control zone or the influence line of an excavation.
- Nails and screws in stripped lumber are pulled or bent flat before stacking. Rebar and other impalement hazards are capped or covered where any person could fall onto them.
- Tools and materials are secured against falling when work occurs overhead; barricades and toe boards protect the level below, and hard hat areas are enforced under it.

16.4 Responsibility

The foreman owns the housekeeping of the work area, the superintendent owns the site, and the yard or shop manager owns the facility. Housekeeping is checked on every weekly

inspection, and a housekeeping deficiency left standing after a request enters the ladder at Step 1 under Chapter 5.

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CHAPTER 17. MATERIAL HANDLING AND ERGONOMICS

Repetitive trauma and manual handling injuries are a leading claims driver for this group. The Ergonomics and Repetitive Motion Injury Prevention Program governs in full; this chapter states the field rules.

17.1 The Program

The Company maintains a written Ergonomics and Repetitive Motion Injury Prevention Program, effective October 15, 2026, covering every Hays Group entity. It sets management responsibility, worker involvement, worksite evaluation, controls, training, early reporting and medical management, records, and annual review, and it satisfies Title 8, Section 5110 for California work. Corporate Safety owns it. Where this chapter and the Program differ, the Program governs. Rigging and hoisting are governed by the Cranes and Rigging module; this chapter and the Program cover what people move by hand and the postures, repetition, and vibration of the work.

17.2 Mechanical Aids First

The first question on any lift is not how to lift it. It is whether a person should be lifting it at all. Excavator rigging, pipe slings and clamps, vault lid and trench plate lifters, pipe carts and rollers, hand trucks, dollies, hose carts and balancers, cable pullers, cone and drum racks, hoists, and jacks exist so that backs do not do machine work. Planning a task includes planning how material moves: to the work, at the work, and away from it. The Program lists the standard aids for each operation. Crews use what is available to them, the foreman records the aid or method on the JHA/PTP, and where the preferred aid is not on site the foreman selects another method under the Program's lifting guidelines and records it. Corporate Safety inventories equipment by crew and the Review Committee fills gaps on a phased plan.

17.3 Manual Lifting

- **Limits.** One person lifts no more than 50 pounds alone under good conditions, and less when the load is awkward, far from the body, lifted from the floor or above the shoulders, or lifted repeatedly. Fifty to 100 pounds is a team lift or mechanical. Over 100 pounds is mechanical, always. Pipe, vault lids, trench plates, shoring components, tires, and batteries above these limits are never lifted by hand. The limits are maximums, not targets.
- Size it up before you touch it: weight, path, footing, and where it lands. If the path is blocked, clear it first.
- Lift with the load close, back straight, legs driving, no twisting; turn with the feet. Set it down the same way.

- Team lift anything awkward, long, or heavier than one person handles comfortably, with one person calling the lift. Asking for a second set of hands is expected, never a knock.
- Where the site and delivery allow, materials are staged at working height, knee to shoulder, close to the point of use, so they are not lifted from the ground, carried over distance, or handled twice.
- Gloves matched to the material, and pinch points identified before the load moves: hands out of the crush zone when setting materials down.

17.4 Repetitive Trauma Prevention

- **Stretch and flex.** Crews do the five-minute routine in the Program as part of the morning tailboard, led by the foreman. A second round after lunch is recommended on heavy or repetitive work days.
- Rotate high-repetition and high-vibration tasks across the crew where the work and crew size allow: shoveling, hose handling, flagging, trowel and vibrator work, cone placement, repetitive hand tool work. Breaks and task variety are planning items, not favors.
- Set up work at the right height where possible: stands, benches, and staging reduce sustained stooping and overhead reaching. Long-handled and extension tools, ratcheting and powered tools, and kneeling pads are the standard for the tasks the Program names.
- Operators and drivers adjust suspension seats and mirrors to themselves, use three points of contact, and take scheduled breaks out of the cab on long shifts. Worn seats are replaced through the fleet maintenance system.
- Employees new to a physically demanding task, or returning from time off or restricted duty, are paired with an experienced employee and eased into the work for the first days.

17.5 Planning and Worker Involvement

- The JHA/PTP (Form 4-B) and the Daily Safety Tailboard (Form 4-A) carry an ergonomics line: the heaviest and most repetitive handling on the task, the aid or method to be used, and who rotates. It is completed with the crew, not for them.
- Any crew member may stop a lift or a task under Chapter 6 and ask for a different method or an aid. Discomfort or doubt is reason enough.
- Crew suggestions, discomfort reports, and evaluation findings go in the central safety log and into Corporate Safety's monthly report to the Review Committee (Chapter 5). Corporate Safety reports back to the crew on what was decided.

17.6 Worksite Evaluation

Corporate Safety, or a superintendent trained by Corporate Safety, evaluates a task for ergonomic risk using the Program checklist when a new task, tool, or operation starts; after any recordable or lost-time sprain, strain, or cumulative trauma injury, as part of the Form 10A investigation; after a discomfort report that meets the Program's criteria; when two or more employees in identical work have physician-diagnosed repetitive motion injuries within twelve months; and annually by operation during site inspections. The employees doing the task are

consulted and their input is recorded. Corrective actions are tracked to closure like any inspection finding.

17.7 Early Reporting

- Early reporting is the control that works. Aches, pain, numbness, tingling, swelling, stiffness, or loss of grip connected to work are reported to the supervisor the same day they are noticed, not when they become a claim. A discomfort report is not an injury claim.
- The supervisor records it on the Program's Discomfort Report, adjusts the task or rotates the employee that day, and sends the form to Corporate Safety and Human Resources before the end of the shift. Corporate Safety reviews it; a full evaluation follows under the criteria in the Program.
- Where symptoms persist or the employee requests it, evaluation at the designated clinic follows Chapter 14, and the event becomes an injury report under Chapter 8. Restrictions are managed under Chapter 24 with regular wages continued on transitional duty.
- Reporting a symptom is never disciplined. Discouraging, delaying, or talking an employee out of a report is a Chapter 5 violation. Supervisors do not diagnose and do not tell anyone to work through pain.

17.8 Training and Records

- Ergonomics is part of orientation under Chapter 23, with an annual refresher delivered through the existing safety meeting and tailboard schedule, task-specific training on assignment to new physical demands, and supervisor training on planning controls, leading stretch and flex, and taking a discomfort report. Delivered in English and Spanish and recorded in the training matrix with a signed acknowledgment.
- Evaluations, discomfort reports, training records, and the annual Program review are kept per Chapter 9 and the Program. Corporate Safety reviews the Program with executive leadership annually and after any cumulative trauma claim.

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CHAPTER 18. HAND AND POWER TOOLS

Powder-actuated tools, powered saws, and specialty equipment carry additional requirements in the applicable work modules.

18.1 The Right Tool, In Good Condition

Injuries with tools come from three places: the wrong tool, a damaged tool, or a defeated guard. All three are within the user's control, and all three are checked before use, every use. Cheater bars, modified tools, and homemade handles are not used. A tool used outside its design (a wrench as a hammer, a screwdriver as a chisel) is the wrong tool.

18.2 Inspection and Removal from Service

- The user inspects before each use: cords and plugs, guards, handles, bits and blades, hoses and fittings. Company tools get a documented periodic inspection per the shop program.
- A damaged or defective tool comes out of service now: tagged DO NOT USE and turned in for repair or destruction. Using a tool with a known defect is treated under Chapter 5 the same as any known-defect operation: Step 3 minimum.

18.3 Guards and Safety Devices

Guards stay on and functional. Removing, pinning, blocking, or otherwise defeating a guard, a trigger safety, or an interlock is removing a safety device: a Tier 1 violation under Chapter 5.4. A tool whose guard must come off for the task is the wrong tool for the task, and the work stops until the right one is on site.

18.4 Power and Environment

- Electric tools run on GFCI protection on construction sites, with cords rated for the service, protected from damage and water, and never carried or lowered by the cord.
- Pneumatic fittings are secured against disconnection (pins or clips plus whip checks on large lines); air is never used to clean clothing or skin.
- Fuel-powered tools are shut off to refuel and are not run in enclosed spaces without ventilation per the applicable module.
- Cutting, grinding, and chipping require the face shield over safety glasses per Chapter 11, hearing protection, and fire watch conditions per Chapter 13 where sparks reach combustibles.

CHAPTER 19. LADDERS

Fall protection above ladder work, scaffolds, and aerial lifts are governed by their own modules.

19.1 Is a Ladder the Right Answer

The first ladder decision is whether to use one at all. For work of any duration, at height, or requiring two hands and force, a scissor lift, boom lift, scaffold, or platform is usually the better and required answer. A ladder is for access and short-duration light work. If you cannot keep three points of contact and stay centered while doing the task, the task does not belong on a ladder.

19.2 Selection

- Duty rating matched to the user plus tools; Type IA or IAA for construction use.
  - Type IA ladders are rated for 300 lbs; Type IAA for 375 lbs. Verify the duty rating label matches the rated load before use, not just the ladder's general condition.
  - Maximum lengths: step ladder, 20 feet; two-section extension (wood), 60 feet; two-section extension (metal), 48 feet; three-section extension (metal), 60 feet; two-section extension (reinforced plastic), 72 feet. A ladder exceeding these lengths for its type is not used regardless of condition or rating.
  - Where 25 or more employees use a ladder at one location, or where two-way ladder traffic is expected, a double-cleat ladder is used, capped at 24 feet.
  - Ladders are never painted or coated with any opaque covering; a coating can hide cracks, splits, or corrosion. Identification or warning labels may be placed on one face of a side rail only.
- Fiberglass, and only fiberglass, anywhere near electrical work or where contact with any conductor is possible. Metal ladders are prohibited in those areas.
- The right length: an extension ladder extends at least 3 feet above the landing and is tied off or secured; a stepladder tall enough that the top two steps are never used, opened fully with spreaders locked, never leaned folded.

19.3 Setup and Use

- Inspected by a qualified person before each use: rails, rungs, feet, spreaders, ropes, and labels. A damaged ladder is tagged "Dangerous, Do Not Use," removed from service immediately, and destroyed or repaired by qualified means, never left where someone can grab it.

- On a two-section extension ladder, the sections overlap by at least: 3 feet for ladders up to 36 feet; 4 feet for ladders over 36 feet up to 48 feet; 5 feet for ladders over 48 feet up to 60 feet. A ladder without adequate overlap for its extended length is not used.
- Set on a firm, level base, feet secured against ice and mud, at 4 to 1 for extension ladders, in a cleared and, where exposed, barricaded area; doors it could be struck through are locked or guarded.
- Three points of contact, facing the ladder, belt buckle inside the rails. Tools go up on a hoist line or in a belt, never carried in the climbing hand.
- One person on a ladder at a time unless it is designed for two. Fall protection applies above the thresholds in the fall protection module, including on fixed ladders per that module.

19.4 Training and Verification

- Every employee who uses a ladder is trained before first use on: selecting the right ladder for the task (length or height needed, working load, duty rating, and how often it's used); erecting a ladder correctly (footing support, top support, securing, and angle of inclination); climbing and working position and points of contact; the factors that contribute to falls (haste, sudden movement, lack of attention, footwear, and physical condition); and prohibited uses (using a ladder for anything other than its designed purpose, climbing the cross-bracing, exceeding maximum lengths, and insufficient overlap on extension sections).
- Supervisors of employees who routinely use ladders receive this same training, not just the employees using the ladders.
- Corporate Safety verifies field application on its assessment rotation: correct ladder selected for the task, duty rating and length within limits, inspection current, setup angle and securing correct, and training on file for the crew present.

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CHAPTER 20. WORKPLACE VIOLENCE PREVENTION

This chapter summarizes the entity's standalone Workplace Violence Prevention Plan under California Labor Code 6401.9; the WVPP document governs in full.

20.1 Policy

Safe-Ex Inc. does not tolerate violence, threats, intimidation, or harassment on its worksites, in its facilities, or in its vehicles, whether from employees, subcontractors, clients, or the public. This applies to conduct in person, by phone, and online where it reaches the workplace. Weapons are prohibited on Company property and worksites except as the law requires the Company to allow.

20.2 What Gets Reported

Employees report every incident, threat, or credible concern to their supervisor, Corporate Safety, or HR, including the four types the law recognizes: violence by an outsider with criminal intent, by a client or member of the public, by a current or former employee, and by someone with a personal relationship to an employee. Public interaction is real exposure for our crews on roadways and rights-of-way: aggressive drivers, confrontations at closures, and threats at work areas are workplace violence incidents and are reported and logged the same as anything internal. Reports can be made without fear of retaliation, and no employee is disciplined for reporting in good faith or for leaving a situation they reasonably believed was dangerous.

20.3 Response and the Violent Incident Log

- Immediate danger: get to safety, call 911, then notify the supervisor. Nobody is expected to confront an aggressor over property or a traffic device.
- Every incident is investigated under the WVPP, and every workplace violence incident is entered in the violent incident log with the detail the statute requires, retained 5 years. Corrective actions (site changes, staffing, client escalation, law enforcement referral) are tracked to closure.
- Employee conduct found to violate this chapter is handled under Chapter 5 and the Employee Handbook; threats and violence enter the ladder at the top.

20.4 Training

Every employee is trained on the WVPP at orientation and annually: the plan, how to report, the hazards specific to their work including public interaction at traffic control and right-of-way locations, and how to respond. Training records per Chapter 9.

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CHAPTER 21. SHORT SERVICE EMPLOYEES

Client SSE programs (ISNetworld and contract exhibits) may set stricter ratios; the stricter rule governs per Chapter 1.

21.1 Who Is an SSE

A Short Service Employee is anyone with less than 6 months of service with the Company, and anyone with less than 6 months in a new craft, role, or entity, regardless of total experience. A 20-year operator new to our work is an SSE for our purposes: they know the machine, they do not yet know us. New employees are statistically at their highest risk of injury in their first months, and this chapter exists because of it.

21.2 The Orientation Gate

No SSE performs field work until orientation is complete: the condensed field handbook delivered and acknowledged, the 7 Rules signed for, entity and client credentials verified per the pre-mobilization requirements, and the training matrix items for the role completed. Orientation is a gate, never a formality, and dispatch does not assign an employee whose gate is open.

21.3 Mentoring and Identification

- Every SSE is assigned a mentor: an experienced crew member designated by the foreman, responsible for pairing with the SSE on tasks, checking understanding at the tailboard, and speaking up on their behalf.
- SSEs are visually identifiable on site per the entity standard (hard hat marking or equivalent) so every crew knows who is new. The marking is a signal for extra eyes, never a target; hazing of new employees is a conduct violation handled under the Handbook.
- Crew composition respects experience: supervisors plan crews so SSEs are distributed, not concentrated, and client SSE ratio limits are honored where they apply.

21.4 Graduation

SSE status ends when the time threshold passes and the foreman and Corporate Safety confirm the training matrix for the role is complete and performance in the field supports it. Concerns extend the mentoring period; a calendar date alone does not end it.

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CHAPTER 22. SUBCONTRACTOR SAFETY MANAGEMENT

Not carried: Safe-Ex Inc. does not engage subcontractors. If that changes, this chapter applies in full and activates by skin reissue. On sites controlled by another Hays Group company or client, that controlling contractor's subcontractor program governs the site, and Safe-Ex Inc. participates as a subcontractor under Chapter 1.

CHAPTER 23. TRAINING AND ORIENTATION

The role-based training matrix is maintained alongside this chapter and loads per entity.

23.1 The System

Training here is a system with a gate, a matrix, and a record, not a stack of certificates. The gate is orientation: nobody works in the field without it. The matrix defines what every role must hold, initially and on refresh. The record proves it, per Chapter 9, and pre-mobilization verification checks it before a crew ships. Pre-mobilization qualification (ISNetworld, RWP and eRailSafe, client credentials) and field orientation are distinct steps: the first proves the gate is satisfied, the second delivers the site and the life-critical subset to the person standing on it.

23.2 Orientation

- Every new hire, rehire, and inter-entity transfer completes entity orientation before field assignment: this manual's field layer (the condensed handbook), the 7 Rules with signed acknowledgment, the Employee Safety Acknowledgment, stop work authority, reporting duties, PPE issue, and the IIPP basics of Chapter 3.
- Orientation is delivered in a language and manner the employee understands, Spanish included where crews require it, with comprehension checked, not assumed.

23.3 The Training Matrix

The matrix maps every role to its required training: regulatory (per this manual and its work sections), certification (operator cards, ATSSA for flagging work, competent person designations, first aid/CPR coverage), client-required (RWP, eRailSafe, client orientations), and refreshers with their cadences. Corporate Safety owns the matrix, tracks expirations, and flags lapses to dispatch and supervisors before they become field problems. An expired requirement means no assignment to the affected work until it is current.

23.4 Delivery and Verification

- Training assigned as a condition of work is paid time, for every employee, always.
- Operating credentials require demonstration, not just attendance: operator cards and competent person designations are issued on evaluated performance per their programs.
- Toolbox talks (weekly minimum) and tailboards (daily) are the field refreshers that keep the formal training alive; both are documented with topic and attendance.
- Training effectiveness is checked in the field: inspections and investigations that find a knowledge gap trigger retraining and a matrix review, per the version control process.

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CHAPTER 24. RETURN TO WORK

The Return to Work Program document governs in full; this chapter states the entity's commitment and the field interface.

24.1 Philosophy

An injured employee is still our employee. The Company's Return to Work Program exists to keep people connected to work, income, and crew while they recover: transitional and modified duty is offered wherever medically appropriate work exists, matched to written restrictions, at no loss of dignity. Staying at work and returning early to real, useful, restriction-compliant tasks produces better medical outcomes than sitting at home, and the Company plans modified assignments the way it plans any other work.

24.2 How It Runs

- Medical care and claims initiation follow Chapter 14 and the claims protocol; the designated clinic is provided the essential functions of the job so restrictions come back specific, not generic.
- HR and Corporate Safety coordinate every restriction with the supervisor. A modified assignment honors the restrictions exactly: a supervisor never asks, hints, or allows an employee to work outside written restrictions, and an employee reports any task that conflicts with theirs. Violations of restrictions are treated as the safety issue they are.
- Modified duty is reviewed at every medical re-evaluation until full release. Communication with the recovering employee is regular and goes through HR and the supervisor; nobody disappears into a claim.
- Filing a claim or accepting modified duty is never retaliated against, period.

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CHAPTER 25. DRIVING AND FLEET SAFETY

The Fleet Management Program, the Driver Acceptability Standards and Disciplinary Matrix, and field procedures P-1 through P-3 are the single source of truth for fleet, DOT, and driver qualification matters; this chapter is the safety manual's interface to them.

25.1 The Rules Every Driver Follows

Rule 6 of the 7 Rules governs every Company vehicle and every piece of mobile equipment: seatbelts on, spotter when backing, phone down. In addition:

- Every occupant belted before the vehicle moves. No exceptions, no short trips.
- No handheld phone use in motion; hands-free minimized and never in complex driving. A call, text, or navigation entry can wait for a stopped, parked vehicle.
- Backing gets a spotter where one is available, and a walk-around when alone. Pull-through and first-move-forward parking are standard practice.
- Speed and following distance matched to conditions, loads secured per the applicable module before the vehicle moves, and impaired or dangerously fatigued driving prohibited under Chapter 15.
- Journey management for long hauls and remote work: route, fuel, rest, and check-in planned before departure per the fleet procedures.

25.2 Authority and Qualification

The Fleet Manager is the authority for vehicle assignment, maintenance, DOT compliance, telematics, and driver qualification under the Fleet Management Program. Only authorized, qualified drivers operate Company vehicles; CDL, medical card, and DOT requirements are tracked under that program, and hours-of-service rules govern covered drivers. Vehicle defects are reported per the fleet inspection procedures, and a vehicle with a safety defect does not roll.

25.3 Events

Every vehicle event (collision, citation, telematics escalation, damage) is reported the same shift under Chapter 8 and handled under the Driver Acceptability Standards and Disciplinary Matrix. Where an event is also a 7 Rules violation, Chapter 5.9 applies: one event, one committee, one outcome.

APPENDIX A. ENTITY INFORMATION AND DESIGNATED PERSONS

SAFE-EX

A1. Entity Identity

Field	Entry
Legal name	Safe-Ex Inc.
Contractor license(s)	CA CSLB #1107365
States of operation	California

A2. Named Persons

Role	Name	Function
Chief Executive Officer	Kirby Hays	Review Committee
Vice President	Karun Mani	Review Committee
Corporate Safety Officer / IIPP Administrator	Sergio Robles	Review Committee; program administration
HR Manager	Desiree Tapia	Review Committee; discipline execution
Field Operations	Jerry Neuman	Advisory to Committee on field impact
Fleet Manager	Derek Alonso	Vehicle, DOT, and driver qualification authority

Entity Role	Name
Operations Lead	Karun Mani

Designated competent persons by discipline, first aid/CPR roster, and operator card holders are maintained in the training matrix by Corporate Safety. To confirm any designation, contact Corporate Safety.

A3. Facilities

Facility	Address
Bakersfield office/yard	3235 Unicorn Road, Bakersfield, CA 93308
Yucaipa yard	32342 Dunlap Blvd, Yucaipa, CA 92399

A4. Chapter Inserts and Switches

Insert	Setting
Ch 5.10 CBA insert	ON: Operating Engineers Local 12

Ch 22 Subcontractor Management	OFF
Ch 12 indoor heat	ON for any shop spaces

A5. Entity PPE Table (additions to the Chapter 11 minimum)

Work	Additional PPE
Hydrovac operations	Per HV-01: hearing protection at the truck, face shield for wand work, rubber gloves/boots for spoils and slurry
Traffic-adjacent work	Class 2/3 per exposure

A6. Work Sections in This Manual

A7. Medical and Posting Information

Posting Item	Entry
Designated occupational clinic(s)	Bakersfield: Concentra Urgent Care, 1800 Westwind Dr Ste 301, Bakersfield, CA 93301. Yucaipa: Concentra Urgent Care, 1375 Camino Real Ste 130, San Bernardino, CA 92408
Nearest emergency room (per facility)	Bakersfield: Adventist Health Bakersfield ER, 2615 Chester Ave, Bakersfield, CA 93301. Yucaipa: Redlands Community Hospital ER, 350 Terracina Blvd, Redlands, CA 92373
Cal/OSHA / ADOSH reporting contact	Corporate Safety Officer: Sergio Robles, 626-366-2912
Jobsite posting kit	Per the Company portable posting kit program, entity-specific

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PART II. WORK MODULES

EXCAVATION, TRENCHING AND SHORING

Utility locating, tolerance zones, and damage prevention follow Module HC-02. Excavations that become confined spaces follow the Confined Space module.

1. Scope and the Absolute Rule

This module governs every excavation and trench: mass excavation, footings, utility trenches, pole holes, and structures. The absolute rule is Rule 4 of the 7 Rules: no person enters a trench 5 feet or deeper without a competent person inspection, a protective system in place, and a way out within 25 feet. Entry into an unprotected trench is a Tier 1 violation under Chapter 5, for the person who enters and for any supervisor who directs or permits it.

A trench does not warn before it collapses. A cubic yard of soil weighs as much as a small car, and a wall lets go in less time than it takes to turn around. Protection is installed before entry because there is no reaction time after.

2. The Competent Person

- Every excavation has a designated competent person, named in the pre-task plan, trained and authorized to classify soil, select protective systems, inspect, and stop work.
- The competent person inspects the excavation, protective systems, and adjacent areas daily before entry, after every rainstorm, after vibration-producing work nearby, after any change in conditions, and as work progresses. Inspections are documented in the daily pre-task plan.
- Soil is classified by the competent person using at least one visual and one manual test. When in doubt, the soil is Type C and the protection is designed accordingly.

3. Cal/OSHA Permit

In California, an annual or project permit from Cal/OSHA is required before constructing any trench or excavation 5 feet or deeper into which a person is required to descend. The permit is obtained before work begins and is available at the site. Out-of-state work follows the host state's permitting requirements per the state addendum.

4. Protective Systems

- Trenches 5 feet or deeper require sloping, benching, shielding, or shoring before entry. Shallower trenches require protection whenever the competent person sees indications of potential cave-in, and layered or previously disturbed soil counts.

- Sloping and benching follow the angles for the classified soil type. Sloping shall follow Cal/OSHA's Table B-1 for excavations less than 20 feet deep:

Soil Type	Angle
Stable Rock	Vertical (90°)
Type A	¾:1 (53°)
Type B	1:1 (45°)
Type C	1 ½:1 (34°)

Soil Type
Angle
Stable Rock
Vertical (90°)
Type A
¾:1 (53°)
Type B
1:1 (45°)
Type C
1 ½:1 (34°)

- Employees are protected from loose rock or soil that could fall or roll from the excavation face onto anyone below: loose material is scaled off before entry, protective barricades are placed at intervals sufficient to stop falling material where scaling alone isn't practical, or another equivalent means is used. This is separate from the protective system protecting against wall collapse — it addresses what can come off or out of an otherwise stable face.
- Trench shields and boxes are used within the manufacturer's tabulated data: depth rating, soil type, and stacking configuration. Workers stay inside the shield's protection; no one works below the shield's bottom edge or outside its walls, and shields are not subjected to loads beyond their rating during installation or movement.
- Shoring is installed and removed per the tabulated data or engineered design, top down going in, bottom up coming out, with workers protected at every stage.
- Excavations deeper than 20 feet require a protective system designed by a registered professional engineer.

5. Access, Egress and the Edge

- A ladder, ramp, or stairway is within 25 feet of lateral travel for every worker in an excavation 4 feet or deeper. Ladders extend 3 feet above the landing and are secured.
- Ramps used solely for employee access are designed by a competent person. Ramps used for equipment access or egress are designed by a competent person qualified in structural design, and built to that design. Ramps built from two or more structural members have those members connected to prevent displacement.
- Spoils, tools, and materials are kept at least 2 feet back from the edge, or restrained. Equipment surcharge loads stay back per the competent person's direction.

- Mobile equipment approaching the edge is controlled with barricades, stop logs, or a spotter when the operator cannot see the edge; the Earthmoving module and HC-02 spotter rules apply around utilities.
- Workers are never under suspended loads or the bucket's swing path, and never ride buckets or equipment into an excavation.
- Walkways and crossings over excavations have guardrails where a fall of 6 feet or more is possible; open excavations are barricaded, covered, or fenced against public and after-hours entry per the Traffic Control module where streets are involved.

6. Water, Atmosphere and Adjacent Structures

- Water accumulation stops entry unless the competent person has controls in place: dewatering monitored while workers are in the trench, and re-inspection after every event.
- Excavations 4 feet or deeper are tested before entry when a hazardous atmosphere exists or could reasonably exist: near gas lines, landfills, contaminated ground, or sewers. Testing, ventilation, and re-testing follow the Confined Space module's atmosphere procedures.
- Excavation below the level of footings, foundations, walls, or utility structures requires support systems, underpinning, or an engineered approach before soil is removed. Sidewalks and pavements are supported where undermined.
- Emergency rescue equipment — breathing apparatus, a safety harness and line, or a basket stretcher — is readily available wherever hazardous atmospheric conditions exist or could reasonably develop, and is attended whenever it's in use.
- Employees entering a bell-bottom pier hole or similar deep, confined footing excavation wear a harness with a lifeline attached, independent of any material-handling line, and attended at all times while the employee is in the excavation.

7. Training and Verification

- Excavation awareness training for every crew member who works in or around excavations; competent person training for those designated.
- Corporate Safety verifies field application on its assessment rotation: protection matches soil and depth, inspection documented today, egress placed, spoils back, permit on site.

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Safe-Ex Inc.

UNDERGROUND UTILITY DAMAGE PREVENTION

Inserts into the entity manual at the work module section.

1. Scope and Principle

This module governs every excavation, potholing, hydrovac, boring, or ground-penetration operation performed near known or suspected underground utilities. It exists because striking a buried line can kill the operator, the spotter, the crew, and the public, and because the controls that prevent a strike degrade during the work, not before it. The principle of this module: a utility you cannot see is a utility you are about to hit. Marking, potholing, and planning establish where a line is. Only continuous visual confirmation keeps mechanical excavation safe while dirt is moving.

Violations of this module involving mechanical excavation near a known live utility are Tier 1 under Chapter 5 (Rule 3, line of fire; Rule 4, excavation protection).

2. Before the Work: Locating and Notification

- A valid regional notification ticket (USA North 811 in California) is on file before any ground disturbance. California law requires notification at least two working days before excavation; the ticket is renewed before it lapses and remains available on site.
- All utility marks are verified against the ticket and the drawings. Unmarked known utilities, discrepancies, or expired marks stop the work before it starts: re-notify and re-mark.
- Within the tolerance zone of any marked subsurface installation, the line is exposed by hand tools or vacuum excavation only. Mechanical excavation inside the tolerance zone before the line is exposed and protected is prohibited.
- Potholing establishes the line's horizontal and vertical position at intervals sufficient to know its path. Where a line changes depth or direction, additional potholes are dug until the geometry is known. Depth and alignment are never assumed from a single exposure.

3. Planning the Dig

- The pre-task plan for any dig near a known utility identifies each line, its exposure status, the no-dig limits communicated to the operator and spotter, equipment positioning, and the stop-work criteria in Section 5.
- The tailboard covers the utility layout with the crew at the excavation, not the trailer: everyone physically sees the marks, the potholes, and the limits.

- Equipment is positioned to minimize blind spots before excavation begins. If the machine's arm, boom, or position blocks the operator's view of the utility, the machine is repositioned before digging, not after.
- The operator's qualification for the specific equipment is verified and documented before assignment. An operator without a current, verified qualification does not run the machine, regardless of schedule pressure.

4. During the Work: Positive Visual Verification

Mechanical excavation within proximity of a known underground utility requires continuous, unobstructed visual confirmation of the utility at all times. The exposed line is protected and delineated so it stays visible:

- Physical delineation beyond paint: lath, flags, stakes, or high-visibility markers along the utility path, and a painted no-mechanical-excavation buffer where practical. Paint on the conduit disappears the moment soil moves; elevated markers do not.
- If soil sloughs onto the line, if any portion of the line becomes obscured, or if the operator loses sight of it for any reason, mechanical excavation stops immediately and the line is re-exposed by hand or vacuum before the bucket moves again.
- The operator never digs from memory, markings alone, assumed alignment, or the visible portion of a line. The full area of potential contact is visually confirmed before each pass.

5. Stop-Work Criteria

Mechanical excavation stops immediately, without waiting for a supervisor, when any of the following occurs. Work resumes only after the condition is corrected and the utility is re-exposed and re-verified:

- Loss of full visibility of the utility, from sloughing soil, spoil placement, equipment position, or worker position.
- Uncertainty about the utility's alignment, depth, or direction, including any point where the line transitions and the geometry has not been potholed.
- The spotter is out of position, task-saturated, or unable to maintain full visual control and communication.
- The operator has a blind spot or obstructed view of the line.
- Any deviation from the planned excavation path or planned conditions.

Stopping work under this section is never a disciplinable act. Failing to stop is.

6. The Dedicated Spotter

A dedicated spotter is required for all mechanical excavation around known live utilities. Dedicated means exactly that:

- The spotter's only task is watching the utility and guiding the operator. No shoveling, no digging, no material handling, no physically protecting one section of line while the bucket works another. A spotter with a shovel in their hands is not a spotter.
- The spotter is positioned to see the entire exposed utility and the bucket's area of contact, and maintains continuous communication with the operator by agreed signals or radio.
- The spotter has explicit stop authority and uses it the moment any Section 5 condition appears.
- Spotter assignments are made by name at the tailboard and documented in the pre-task plan. An employee removed from spotter duty under Chapter 5 is not reassigned to it until re-qualified by Corporate Safety.

7. If a Line Is Contacted or Damaged

- Stop all work immediately. Shut down the machine. Keep everyone clear.
- Treat every contacted line as live. Do not touch, move, backfill, or repair a damaged line.
- Electrical contact: the operator stays on the machine unless fire forces exit; if exiting, jump clear with feet together and shuffle away. Crew stays back from step potential.
- Gas or unknown product: evacuate upwind, eliminate ignition sources, and keep the public clear.
- Notify, in order: the supervisor, the utility owner and 911 where the situation requires, Corporate Safety, and the one-call center as required by law. Preserve the scene per Chapter 8; nothing is removed or disturbed until the investigation directs it.
- Every contact, including damage limited to conduit with no service impact, is reported before end of shift and investigated on Form 10A. Concealing a strike or damage is a Step 3 minimum offense under Chapter 5 and grounds for termination.

8. Training and Verification

- Initial training on this module for every operator, spotter, laborer, foreman, and superintendent assigned to excavation near utilities, with refresher at least annually and after any strike or near miss.
- Operators complete positive verification retraining after any incident in which visual confirmation was lost.
- Corporate Safety verifies field application through its assessment rotation: delineation in place, dedicated spotter in position, stop-work criteria known by name on the crew.

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Safe-Ex Inc.

EARTHMOVING AND HEAVY EQUIPMENT

Governs excavators, loaders, dozers, graders, compactors, and skid steers in all operations.

1. Scope and Principle

This module governs mobile earthmoving equipment. Two things kill around this iron: unqualified hands on the controls, and people on foot inside the machine's working envelope. Both are controlled by verification and position, not by trust.

Operating equipment without verified qualification, and assigning an operator without verifying qualification, are Chapter 5 violations for the operator and the assigning supervisor alike.

2. Operator Qualification and Assignment

- Every operator holds a current, documented qualification for the specific class of equipment before the seat time starts. The supervisor verifies and documents the qualification in the pre-task plan before assignment; schedule pressure, customer pressure, and operational need never override this.
- Trainees operate only under a designated qualified trainer, in controlled conditions, documented as training time.
- Qualification records are tracked centrally; an expired or unverifiable qualification comes off the equipment schedule until resolved.

3. Pre-Operation and Equipment Condition

- Documented pre-shift inspection per the manufacturer: controls, brakes, alarms, cameras and mirrors, glass, fire extinguisher, and seatbelt. Defects are reported per the Equipment Damage Standard; safety-critical defects park the machine.
- Backup alarms and cameras are life-safety devices: a machine with a dead alarm does not work around people on foot, period.
- Mounting and dismounting uses three points of contact, facing the machine, never jumping and never with hands full.

4. The Working Envelope

- The swing radius and travel path of every machine is a controlled zone: nobody on foot inside it without positive communication with the operator. Eye contact and acknowledgment before approach, every time, no matter how many years the two people have worked together.

- Ground personnel and operators own the rule jointly: the operator shuts down or holds when someone must enter the envelope; the person on foot never assumes they were seen.
- Spotters are used when backing where vision is limited (Rule 6), around utilities per HC-02, and near edges per HC-01. Spotter positioning keeps an escape path and never puts the spotter between the machine and a fixed object.
- Loads travel low; buckets and blades never pass over people, cabs, or occupied vehicles; and nobody rides buckets, hitches, or steps.
- Slopes, edges, and benches are worked per the competent person's direction and the machine's limits; undercutting the bench you sit on has buried machines and operators together.

5. Shutdown and Securing

- Attachments grounded, parking brake set, controls neutralized, and key controlled at every dismount; a running machine is never left unattended.
- Equipment parked for the day is grounded, secured against movement and vandal start, and positioned clear of traffic and drainage.

6. Training and Verification

- Qualification per equipment class with practical evaluation; refresher after incidents, damage events, or observed deficiencies per the Equipment Damage Standard.
- Corporate Safety verifies on rotation: qualifications documented in the pre-task plan, envelope discipline, alarms functional, seatbelts on.

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Safe-Ex Inc.

MODULE HC-06. SILICA EXPOSURE CONTROL

The written exposure control plan for respirable crystalline silica. Anchored to 29 CFR 1926.1153 and T8 CCR 1532.3. Replaces the legacy Silica Exposure Control Program chapters.

1. The Rule

Cutting, grinding, drilling, sawing, milling, jackhammering, or sweeping concrete, masonry, stone, or asphalt generates respirable silica, and silica destroys lungs permanently. No dry cutting, dry grinding, or dry sweeping of these materials. Ever. Water or vacuum, or the work does not happen.

2. Control Methods

- Tasks follow Table 1 of the standard: the specified engineering control (integrated water delivery or shroud-and-HEPA-vacuum), used exactly as specified, with the respiratory protection Table 1 assigns for the task and duration. The Table 1 task list and controls are part of the pre-task plan for any silica work.
- Tasks not on Table 1, or performed outside its conditions, require an exposure assessment through Corporate Safety before the work proceeds.
- Housekeeping in silica areas: wet methods or HEPA vacuum. Compressed air, dry sweeping, and dry brushing are prohibited for silica dust.
- Cut stations are positioned and shielded so dust does not drift onto adjacent workers or the public; downwind exposure counts.

3. Program Elements

- The competent person for silica is designated in writing by Corporate Safety and tracked in the training matrix: makes frequent inspections of silica work, has authority to correct, and verifies water flow and vacuum function before and during the task.
- Respirators used under this module follow IH-02 in full: medical evaluation, fit test, clean-shaven.
- Medical surveillance is offered to every employee required to wear a respirator under this module 30 or more days per year, per the standard's schedule, coordinated by HR confidentially.
- Training at assignment and refresher: health effects, the tasks that generate exposure, the Table 1 controls for their work, and this plan. Documented per Chapter 9.

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MODULE HC-07. WORKING NEAR AND OVER WATER

Governs work over or adjacent to water where drowning is a hazard: channels, basins, canals, culverts, and rail or road structures over water.

1. Flotation and Rescue

- Every employee working over or near water where drowning is possible wears a US Coast Guard approved life jacket or buoyant vest, inspected before each use. Hi-vis flotation where traffic or equipment exposure overlaps.
- Ring buoys with at least 90 feet of line are provided at intervals not exceeding 200 feet along the exposure. Where employees work over water, a rescue skiff or equivalent rescue capability is immediately available and a rescue plan is part of the tailboard: who, how, and current/outfall hazards.
- Fall protection over water follows VB-01 where a fall arrest solution exists; flotation supplements it, never replaces it.

2. Water Conditions

- Flow, depth, temperature, and release schedules are checked before work in channels and canals; work in a channel subject to releases or storm flow requires an upstream warning method and an escape plan, briefed.
- Culvert interior work is evaluated for confined space per EL-04 before entry; flowing water in a culvert adds an engulfment hazard that must be isolated or controlled.
- Cold water and cold weather immersion risk is part of the plan: dry changes of clothing staged, and no lone work over water, anywhere, ever.

3. Equipment Near Water

- Equipment working adjacent to banks and edges follows HC-05 slope and edge rules with the bank treated as undermined until verified; spotters for any approach within the influence line of the bank.
- Night or low-visibility work over water is lit, and the rescue plan is re-briefed for darkness.

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Safe-Ex Inc.

ROADWAY WORKER PROTECTION AND ON-TRACK SAFETY

Applies to any employee whose duties place them on or near railroad property. Based on 49 CFR Part 214 Subpart C and host railroad rules.

1. Scope and the Absolute Rule

This module governs all work on or near railroad property: track work, culverts and bridges, utility crossings, subsurface work in rail corridors, and traffic control or support setup inside railroad right of way. The host railroad's rules (Union Pacific, BNSF, or other operators) govern on their property and are incorporated by reference; where this module and the railroad's rules differ, the stricter applies.

The absolute rule is Rule 5 of the 7 Rules: no employee fouls a track until on-track safety is established and the job briefing is complete. Fouling a track means being on the track or close enough to it to be struck by a train or on-track equipment, and it includes tools, equipment, and material, not just people. Fouling a track without established on-track safety is a Tier 1 violation under Chapter 5.

2. Qualification Before Entry

- No employee enters railroad right of way without current roadway worker protection training, the host railroad's contractor orientation and badging (eRailSafe or equivalent where required), and any site-specific qualification the railroad requires. No current card, no entry. There are no exceptions for short tasks, deliveries, or visits.
- Crews that work railroad property infrequently receive, in addition to current training, a pre-mobilization briefing from Corporate Safety before each assignment. Infrequent work is the highest-risk case: familiarity cannot be assumed, so it is rebuilt before every entry.
- The supervisor verifies and documents every crew member's qualification in the pre-task plan before mobilization. An unqualified worker found on railroad property stops the work.

3. On-Track Safety Methods

Every task that fouls a track is protected by one of the following, established with the railroad before work begins and named in the job briefing:

- Working limits: exclusive occupancy of a defined track segment, established through the railroad (foul time, track and time, or the railroad's equivalent). No train enters the limits while they are in effect. This is the preferred method for our work.

- Train approach warning: a qualified watchman or lookout dedicated solely to detecting approaching trains and warning the crew in time for everyone to clear to a predetermined place of safety. Used only where working limits are not available and the railroad's rules permit it.
- Inaccessible track: the track is physically inaccessible to trains through switches lined and locked, derails, or disconnects, per the railroad's procedures.

Individual train detection is not an authorized method for our employees. If the railroad proposes it, the work is re-planned under working limits or train approach warning.

4. The Job Briefing

Before any employee fouls a track, the roadway worker in charge conducts a job briefing that covers: the on-track safety method in effect and its limits, tracks affected and adjacent live tracks, expected train and equipment movements, the predetermined place of safety and the clearing route to it, communication and warning signals, and the time the protection expires. Every employee acknowledges the briefing before fouling. The briefing is repeated whenever conditions change, protection changes, the crew changes, or work moves to a different location. No briefing, no fouling.

5. The Watchman/Lookout

- Watchman duty is a dedicated assignment, identical in principle to the dedicated spotter in the utility module: the watchman does nothing but watch for trains and warn the crew. No tools, no phone, no other tasks. A watchman doing anything else is not a watchman, and the crew is unprotected.
- Warning is given early enough for every worker, with tools and equipment, to be clear of the track and in the place of safety at least 15 seconds before a train moving at maximum authorized speed arrives, or the longer time the railroad requires.
- Watchmen are assigned by name at the briefing, positioned for sight distance in both directions, and relieved for breaks by a qualified replacement with a handoff briefing. If the watchman loses sight lines or communication, everyone clears the track until protection is re-established.

6. Adjacent Tracks, Equipment, and Clearances

- Protection on one track protects that track only. Adjacent live tracks are treated as live: no person, tool, or equipment fouls an adjacent track outside the established protection.
- Cranes, excavators, and any boomed equipment working near track operate under the Cranes and Rigging module with railroad-approved clearances and, where required, a railroad flagman or employee-in-charge present. Swing radius and boom travel never foul a protected or live track without explicit protection.
- Hi-rail and on-track equipment operate under the railroad's rules and the operator qualification requirements of the Earthmoving module.

7. If a Train Approaches or Protection Fails

- On any warning, uncertainty, or loss of protection: clear the track immediately to the predetermined place of safety, take tools if it is instant, leave them if it is not, and account for every person.
- Work does not resume until the roadway worker in charge confirms protection and re-briefs the crew.
- Any near miss with a train or on-track equipment, any protection failure, and any unauthorized fouling is reported the same shift and investigated on Form 10A. The railroad's reporting requirements are followed in parallel.

8. Training and Verification

- Annual roadway worker protection training for every employee assigned to railroad work, plus the host railroad's requirements, with records maintained per Chapter 9 and available at the jobsite.
- Drug and alcohol requirements for railroad work, including FRA Part 219 where applicable, are governed by the Combined Drug and Alcohol Policy.
- Corporate Safety verifies field application on its assessment rotation: briefing documented, method in effect matches the briefing, watchman dedicated, place of safety real and reachable.

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Safe-Ex Inc.

MODULE EL-01. ELECTRICAL SAFETY AWARENESS

For unqualified workers: everyone who works near electricity without being qualified to work on it. Replaces the legacy Electrical Safety Awareness chapters. Qualified electrical work is governed by EL-05.

1. The Line You Do Not Cross

Unqualified workers never work on, open, or reach into energized electrical equipment. Panels stay closed, covers stay on, and anything electrical that is broken, smoking, buzzing, or wet gets distance and a report, not a look inside.

2. Overhead Lines

- Every overhead line is energized until the utility confirms otherwise in writing. Minimum approach for unqualified workers and equipment: 10 feet up to 50kV, more for higher voltages per the applicable table, and the table distances are airgap to any part of the machine, load, or tool.
- Equipment working near lines gets a dedicated spotter with no other duties, marked travel paths, and where the utility provides it, cover-up or de-energization arranged before the work. Booms, dumps (TR-02), ladders, and scaffold components are the repeat killers near lines.
- A machine that contacts a line: operator stays on the machine unless fire forces a jump-and-shuffle exit; everyone else stays back at least 35 feet and nobody touches the machine. 911 and the utility, immediately.

3. Cords, Tools, and Temporary Power

- GFCI protection for cord-connected tools on construction sites, cords rated and undamaged (no tape repairs), protected from crush and water, and plugs with grounding pins intact. Damaged means out of service per Chapter 18.
- Temporary power is installed and modified by qualified persons only; unqualified workers do not reset breakers on equipment circuits without knowing why they tripped.

4. Underground

- Buried electrical follows HC-02 in full: located, potholed, and treated as live. A damaged underground electrical line is a Chapter 13 utility emergency.

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Safe-Ex Inc.

CONFINED SPACE ENTRY

Governs entry into vaults, manholes, tanks, culverts, shafts, and every other space that can trap or kill the person inside it.

1. Scope and Principle

This module governs confined spaces: spaces large enough to enter, with limited entry and exit, not designed for continuous occupancy. Vaults, manholes, tanks, culverts, deep shafts, and pits qualify, and so does any excavation the atmosphere or configuration turns into one. The principle: the space is permit-required until evaluation proves otherwise, and the atmosphere is unbreathable until the meter proves otherwise.

Entering a permit space without a permit, attendant, and tested atmosphere, and entering to rescue without training and equipment, are Tier 1 violations under Chapter 5. Would-be rescuers are the majority of confined space fatalities.

2. Evaluation and Classification

- Spaces on every project are identified at planning and classified by the competent person with Corporate Safety; permit-required spaces are posted or otherwise communicated so nobody enters casually.
- Reclassification and alternate procedures are used only where the standard allows, documented, and approved by Corporate Safety.

3. The Entry

- A written permit before entry: hazards, isolation, atmosphere readings, equipment, entrants, attendant, supervisor, rescue plan, and duration. The permit lives at the space during entry.
- Energy and flow isolation per the LOTO module: lines blanked, blocked, or double-valved per the plan, and upstream water controlled at culverts and drainage structures.
- Atmosphere tested with a calibrated, bump-tested meter, in order: oxygen, flammables, then toxics, at all levels of the space, before entry and continuously during it. Ventilation runs as the plan requires, and readings out of range clear the space immediately.
- An attendant remains outside the entire entry: tracking entrants, monitoring conditions, maintaining communication, and summoning rescue. The attendant performs no other duties and never enters, even to help.
- Retrieval equipment per the plan: harness and line with a mechanical retrieval device at vertical entries unless it increases risk, documented when not used.

- Rescue is arranged before entry: a service or team that can respond in time with confined space rescue capability, verified, not assumed from the local fire department without confirmation. Calling 911 is notification, not a rescue plan.

4. Training and Verification

- Entrant, attendant, and entry supervisor training per role before assignment; meter operation and bump testing as verified skills; annual refresher and after any incident.
- Corporate Safety verifies on rotation: permits complete and posted, attendant dedicated, meters calibrated, rescue verified.

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Safe-Ex Inc.

MODULE EL-06. CRITICAL FACILITY AND SUBSTATION ACCESS

Governs work inside client critical facilities: substations, switchyards, generating and communications facilities, and secure client sites. The client's site protocol governs; this module is the floor beneath it.

1. Access Is Earned Daily

- Entry requires the client's authorization for each person: badging, orientation, and escort requirements verified at pre-mobilization and again at the gate. Nobody unbadged, nobody unescorted where escort is required, and access lists are kept current with dispatch.
- The client's minimum approach distances, barriers, and grounded zones are absolute. Inside a substation, everything is energized unless the client's authorized person declares and demonstrates otherwise; our crews never operate client switching, breakers, or grounds. Ever.

2. Working Inside

- The client's daily briefing or switching order is attended and followed; our pre-task plan incorporates it, and any conflict stops work until the client resolves it.
- Barricades and flagging define our work envelope; stepping outside the envelope, even to retrieve a tool, requires the escort or authorized person.
- Tools, equipment, and material heights are managed against overhead clearances per EL-01, with dielectric considerations for anything long or conductive; measuring devices near energized equipment are non-conductive.
- Excavation inside facilities follows HC-01/HC-02 with the client's drawings treated as incomplete until verified: substations are dense with unmarked cable and ground grid, and the ground grid is a utility.

3. Security and Reporting

- No photography, no unescorted deliveries, no propped gates or doors; client security rules are safety rules here. Any incident, alarm, contact with equipment, or security event is reported to the client's contact and Corporate Safety immediately, same shift, per Chapter 8.

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Safe-Ex Inc.

MODULE US-02. UTILITY LOCATING AND GPR OPERATIONS

The GSSSI anchor module: electromagnetic locating, ground penetrating radar, marking, and positive response. Works as the front end of HC-02; excavation crews rely on this work being right.

1. The Product Is Protection

A locate is a safety-critical deliverable. Marks that are wrong or incomplete put a digging crew onto a live line. Locates are performed to the standard, documented, and never guessed: where a line cannot be found or verified, the deliverable says so plainly, and the digging crew treats the area per HC-02 unknown-utility rules.

2. Field Operations

- Locating follows the 811 one-call framework and the client scope: records review first, then field sweep with instruments matched to the target, marking in APWA uniform color code with offsets and depth qualifiers per the standard. Depth readings are estimates and are labeled as estimates.
- GPR and locating on roadways, shoulders, and parking areas is live-traffic work: TC-02 applies in full, with vehicle positioning as shield, Class 2/3 apparel, and TC-01 setups where the exposure requires a closure.
- Lone-worker exposure is the norm in this work: check-in schedule per AG/lone-worker practice in this manual (Chapter 13/14 emergency info), charged communications, and location sharing with dispatch for remote corridors.
- Site hazards get the same respect as any crew's: dogs and property access, terrain, vaults and lids (no entry: EL-04 governs any entry), and confined space instrument drops done from outside the space.

3. Documentation

- Every locate produces the record: what was searched, what was found, what was marked, what could not be verified, photos where the client scope requires. Positive response is entered in the system on time; a late or missing response is a compliance failure, not an oversight.
- Equipment is calibrated and function-checked per the manufacturer; a locator that fails its check is out of service per Chapter 18.

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Safe-Ex Inc.

HYDROVAC AND VACUUM EXCAVATION OPERATIONS

Works together with Module HC-02 (Underground Utility Damage Prevention): HC-02 governs the dig decisions, this module governs the equipment and the operation.

1. Scope

This module governs hydro vacuum excavation and air vacuum excavation: potholing and daylighting utilities, slot trenching, pole hole excavation, debris and spoils removal, and vault and structure cleanouts. It covers the truck, the boom, the wand, the spoils, and the people around them. Utility locating, notification tickets, tolerance zones, stop-work criteria, and damage response follow Module HC-02 without exception; vacuum excavation is the preferred method of exposing utilities precisely because it is the low-energy option, and this module keeps it that way.

2. Operator Qualification and Pre-Operation

- Only employees qualified on the specific unit operate it. Qualification is documented and verified before assignment; drivers of the truck itself meet the requirements of the Fleet Management Program and the Combined Drug and Alcohol Policy.
- Pre-operation inspection each shift covers the chassis pre-trip plus the vac system: boom function and interlocks, hoses and clamps, wand condition, pressure relief, tank door seals and safety props, water system, and emergency stops. Defects take the unit out of service; operating through a known defect is a Chapter 5 matter.
- The digging plan, tickets, marks, and tolerance zones are reviewed at the tailboard per HC-02 before the first pothole of the shift.

3. Truck and Boom Positioning

- The truck is positioned on stable ground, clear of the excavation's zone of influence, with spoils load and slope considered before the tank fills. A loaded debris tank changes the truck's weight by tons; position for the end of the job, not the start.
- Overhead lines are located before the boom moves. Booms, masts, and raised tank bodies maintain at least 10 feet of clearance from energized overhead lines up to 50 kV, and greater distances at higher voltages per the applicable standard and the utility owner's rules. Where clearance cannot be assured, a dedicated observer directs boom movement.
- The operator maintains visual contact with the boom and digging area, or works with a dedicated observer when the view is obstructed. Boom travel never passes over workers.

- Working from or in traffic follows the Traffic Control module and the working near live traffic module; the truck is positioned to shield the operator and wand hand where the closure design allows.

4. Jetting and Vacuum Operations

- Hand and body parts never approach the vacuum tube inlet while the system is under vacuum. The tube is controlled with handles and positioned tools, never by cupping the inlet.
- High pressure water cuts skin and injects contaminants; a jetting wand is treated like a cutting tool. The wand is never pointed at any person, and the operator wears face and eye protection, hearing protection, waterproof gloves and boots, and hi-visibility rated for the work area.
- Near utilities, pressure is reduced and the stream is kept moving. A pressurized stream is never held stationary on a utility, its coating, or its tracer wire. Expose progressively around the line per HC-02; the goal is soil removal, not surface cleaning of a live line.
- Water heat, where equipped, is limited near coated pipe, plastic gas lines, and direct-buried cable per the utility owner's requirements.
- Dry vacuum work on fine or combustible material uses the manufacturer's bonding and grounding provisions to control static.
- Slips and mud are part of this work: slurry on hardscape is contained and cleaned as the work proceeds, not at the end of shift.

5. Open Excavations and Public Protection

- No pothole or excavation is left open and unattended without positive protection: cover plates rated for the exposure, or barricades and delineation per the Traffic Control module, plus marking. In pedestrian areas the protection is fixed, not cones alone.
- Potholes are backfilled or plated before demobilizing each day unless the client's approved plan says otherwise, and the condition left behind is documented with photos.
- Excavations deep enough for entry are governed by the Excavation module; nobody enters a vacuum-excavated hole that meets trench depth thresholds without protective systems, and vaults and manholes are Confined Space module territory including atmosphere testing where gas lines are nearby.

6. Spoils and Slurry Management

- Slurry and spoils go to legal disposal only, at approved facilities, with disposal tickets retained to the project file. Nothing is discharged to storm drains, gutters, waterways, or the ground without authorization.
- Tank doors are opened only with the boom and body properly supported, the door restrained, and personnel clear of the swing and the discharge path. Nobody works behind an unrestrained tank door.
- Loads are managed against legal weight limits per the Fleet Management Program; the operator confirms tank load before travel.

7. Training and Verification

- Initial qualification per unit type, annual refresher, and retraining after any incident, near miss, or observed deficiency.
- Every hydrovac operator and tender completes the HC-02 damage prevention training; on utility exposure work the two modules are one operation.
- Corporate Safety verifies field application on its assessment rotation: clearances honored, wand discipline, open holes protected, disposal tickets current.

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Safe-Ex Inc.

HYDROGEN SULFIDE MONITORING AND RESPONSE

Applies to work where hydrogen sulfide exposure is reasonably possible, such as wet utility, sewer-adjacent, and certain subsurface work.

1. Scope and Principle

This module applies where hydrogen sulfide is reasonably possible: sewer and wet utility work, certain vaults and wet wells, and subsurface work in areas with known H2S history. H2S announces itself with rotten-egg odor at low levels and then deadens the nose exactly when concentrations become dangerous; odor is a first warning, never a measurement, and never an all-clear.

The meter is the only judge. Entering or continuing work in a suspected H2S atmosphere without monitoring is a Tier 1 violation under Chapter 5.

2. Monitoring and Controls

- Tasks identified for H2S exposure carry calibrated, bump-tested monitors with H2S sensors, worn in the breathing zone of exposed workers; alarm setpoints follow the applicable exposure limits.
- Confined and below-grade spaces in H2S-possible work are entered only under the Confined Space module with continuous monitoring and ventilation per the permit.
- Any alarm clears the area upwind and uphill immediately; work resumes only after ventilation and re-testing bring the space within limits, per the entry supervisor.
- A worker down in a suspected H2S atmosphere is a rescue-team event: nobody enters after them without supplied air and training. This is the confined space rescue rule at its most unforgiving.

3. Training and Verification

- H2S awareness and monitor use training for crews assigned to H2S-possible work, with bump testing as a verified skill.
- Corporate Safety verifies on rotation: monitors present, calibrated, and worn where the task list requires them.

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MODULE IH-01. NOISE AND HEARING CONSERVATION

The hearing conservation program. Anchored to 29 CFR 1926.52/1910.95 and T8 CCR 5095 series. Replaces the legacy Noise Exposure Program chapters.

1. The Standard

- At or above an 8-hour average of 85 dBA, the hearing conservation program applies: protection provided, training delivered, and audiometric testing offered per the standard. A working test: if you must raise your voice to be understood at arm's length, protection goes in.
- Posted high-noise areas and designated high-noise equipment (impact tools, milling, pile driving, vacuum blowers, grinding, saws, shop air tools) require protection every time, full stop.
- Dual protection (plugs plus muffs) for the loudest operations: impact pile driving, extended jackhammer work, and any operation so designated by Corporate Safety.

2. Program Elements

- Protection is provided at no cost in at least two forms; fit and use are taught, not assumed, and protectors are matched to the exposure so speech and alarms remain audible.
- Audiometric testing: baseline within the standard's window for covered employees and annual tests thereafter, coordinated confidentially by HR; standard threshold shifts trigger refit, retraining, and follow-up per the standard.
- Buy quiet and keep quiet: equipment purchases consider noise, mufflers and enclosures are maintained, and a missing muffler is an equipment defect, not a personality trait.
- Training annually for covered employees: effects of noise, purpose and use of protectors, and the audiometric program. Documented per Chapter 9.

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Safe-Ex Inc.

MODULE IH-02. RESPIRATORY PROTECTION

The written respiratory protection program. Anchored to 29 CFR 1910.134 and T8 CCR 5144. Replaces the legacy Respiratory Protection Program chapters. Program administrator: the Corporate Safety Officer.

1. Hierarchy First

Respirators are the control of last resort: engineering controls (water, ventilation, vacuum capture) and work practice controls come first, per HC-06, VB-08, and the applicable modules. Where respirators are required, this program applies in full.

2. Required Use

- No employee wears a required respirator until three gates are passed: confidential medical evaluation cleared; fit test passed on the exact make, model, and size, repeated at least annually; and training on use, limitations, seal checks, and maintenance.
- Clean-shaven where the facepiece seals. No seal, no respirator, no exposure: the task waits or the controls change.
- Selection is by exposure per the module or assessment: filtering facepieces and half-masks for particulates per Table 1 and assigned tasks; anything beyond (supplied air, IDLH, emergency response) requires a specific Corporate Safety plan before the work.
- User seal check every donning; cartridges and filters changed per the change schedule or at breakthrough/loading; respirators cleaned, inspected, and stored protected.

3. Voluntary Use

- Voluntary filtering facepiece (dust mask) use is permitted where no exposure requires protection; the user receives the standard's Appendix D advisory. Voluntary use of anything beyond a filtering facepiece requires medical clearance.

4. Records

- Medical clearances, fit tests, and training are tracked in the training matrix and retained per Chapter 9; expired fit test means no assignment to respirator-required work until renewed.

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Safe-Ex Inc.

MODULE TC-02. WORKING NEAR LIVE TRAFFIC

For every crew exposed to live traffic without running the closure: locating, inspection, survey, utility work on shoulders, short-duration stops. TC-01 governs entities providing traffic control; this module governs exposure.

1. Rule 5 Applies to You

Live traffic kills the people who were just there for a minute. Rule 5 of the 7 Rules applies to every person on foot near a live lane: nobody steps into a live lane, ever, outside established control. Short-duration and mobile operations still require the protection the CA MUTCD prescribes for them; quick does not mean exempt.

2. Position and Protection

- Park the vehicle as protection: upwind of the work between traffic and the crew where practical, wheels turned so a struck vehicle deflects away from the work, lights and beacon on. Exit the vehicle away from traffic and work off the traffic side only when the task leaves no choice and the exposure is briefed.
- Class 2 high-visibility apparel minimum, Class 3 at night and on high-speed facilities. Hi-vis is worn fastened and outermost.
- Face traffic whenever the task allows; when the task forces your back to traffic, someone else watches for you. Nobody works alone with their back to live lanes.
- Escape route identified before starting: where you go when a vehicle leaves the roadway. It is part of the two-minute tailboard even for a ten-minute stop.

3. When the Task Outgrows the Stop

- If the work requires occupying a shoulder beyond a brief stop, entering a lane, or diverting pedestrians, it requires devices and a setup per the MUTCD: cones, signs, or a TC-01 closure by a qualified crew. Escalating protection is a scheduling call, never a personal risk decision by the person exposed.
- Distraction rules mirror TC-01: no phones or earbuds while exposed, and weather or visibility that defeats driver reaction distance suspends the exposure.

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Safe-Ex Inc.

MODULE TR-01. DOT / FMCSA FLEET COMPLIANCE POINTER

Pointer module: the Fleet Management Program is the single source of truth for all DOT and FMCSA matters. This module tells every entity where those obligations live and who owns them; it duplicates nothing.

1. What Lives in the Fleet Program

- Driver qualification files, CDL and medical certificate tracking, and the driver roster: owned by the Fleet Manager.
- Hours of service, ELD administration, and exemption determinations.
- Vehicle inspection program: pre-trip and post-trip DVIR requirements, periodic inspections, and out-of-service criteria. A written-up safety defect parks the vehicle per Chapter 25.
- DOT drug and alcohol program under 49 CFR Part 382, administered through the Combined Drug and Alcohol Policy, including post-accident testing decision criteria.
- CSA scores, roadside inspection results, and DataQ challenges.

2. What This Manual Adds

- The safety consequence layer: Rule 6, Chapter 25 driving rules, Chapter 15 fitness and fatigue, and the Chapter 5.9 one-event-one-committee rule for events that are both DOT matters and safety violations.
- Same-shift reporting of every roadside inspection, citation, collision, and out-of-service order to the Fleet Manager and Corporate Safety per Chapter 8.

3. Who Is Covered

- Every driver of a CMV as defined by the regulations, at every entity that operates one, per the Fleet Program's applicability determinations. Whether a vehicle or driver is DOT-covered is the Fleet Manager's call, made in writing, not a foreman's guess.

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Safe-Ex Inc.

HAZARDOUS MATERIALS, WASTE AND SPILL RESPONSE

Governs chemical storage, handling, waste streams, and spill response in shops, yards, and the field.

1. Scope

This module governs hazardous materials from arrival to disposal: fuels, oils, coolants, solvents, treatment chemicals, batteries, and the wastes the work generates. Hazard communication (labels, SDS, training) is this manual chapter; this module is the physical handling.

2. Storage and Handling

- Flammables live in rated cabinets or approved storage areas, quantities within limits, away from ignition and exits; incompatibles (acids and bases, oxidizers and fuels) are separated by distance or containment.
- Every container is labeled; transfer containers get workplace labels the moment product goes in. An unlabeled jug gets treated as unknown and disposed properly, not sniffed and guessed.
- Bulk fuel and lube storage has secondary containment sized per the rules, inspected on the facility schedule, with fill and dispense procedures that keep hoses attended and drips caught.
- Field fueling follows the bonding, attended-nozzle, and no-ignition rules everywhere the truck goes; fuel and chemical transport in vehicles follows the quantity and securement rules of the Fleet Management Program.

3. Waste Streams

- Used oil, coolant, solvents, filters, absorbents, batteries, and aerosols each go into their designated, labeled accumulation containers; nothing is mixed, and nothing goes into the trash, the ground, or a drain.
- Accumulation areas are inspected on the facility schedule, containers closed except when adding, and pickups by licensed vendors documented with manifests retained.
- Hydrovac slurry, treatment chemical waste, and contaminated soil follow the disposal requirements in their modules with manifests to the project file.

4. Spill Response

- Spill kits are staged at fixed stations in shops and yards and on every service and hydrovac truck, stocked for the products carried, and checked on the inspection cycle.
- Small spills within the crew's training are stopped at the source, contained ahead of drains and soil, absorbed, and cleaned, with waste disposed as hazardous; drains are protected first because a spill that reaches water changes jurisdiction.

- Spills beyond the crew's training or products, or any spill reaching soil, water, or a drain, escalate immediately: isolate the area, notify the supervisor and Corporate Safety, and make the agency notifications the law requires within their time limits. Reportable quantities and numbers are posted with the spill kits.
- Every spill, including recovered ones, is reported the same shift and logged per Chapter 8.

5. Training and Verification

- Handling and spill response training for shop, fueling, hydrovac, and treatment crews; awareness for everyone per the hazcom chapter.
- Corporate Safety verifies on rotation: labeling, containment condition, kit stocking, manifest files current.

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